

VIVEKANAND EDUCATION SOCIETY'S INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

(An Autonomous Institute Affiliated to University of Mumbai

Department of Computer Engineering)

Department of Computer Engineering



Project Report on

NeuroSplain : Interpretable Multi-Modal Framework for Alzheimer's Disease Detection

In partial fulfillment of the Fourth Year (Semester–VII), Bachelor of Engineering

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CERTIFICATE of Approval

This is to certify that _____ of Fourth Year

Computer Engineering studying under the University of Mumbai has satisfactorily presented the project on “*NeuroSplain : Interpretable Multi-Modal Framework for Alzheimer's Disease Detection*” as a part of the coursework of PROJECT-I for Semester-VII under the guidance of *Dr. Indu Dokare* in the year 2025-2026.

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Computer Engineering Department

COURSE OUTCOMES FOR B.E PROJECT

Learners will be to:-

Course Outcome	Description of the Course Outcome
CO 1	Do literature survey/industrial visit and identify the problem of the selected project topic.
CO2	Apply basic engineering fundamental in the domain of practical applications FOR problem identification, formulation and solution
CO 3	Attempt & Design a problem solution in a right approach to complex problems
CO 4	Cultivate the habit of working in a team
CO 5	Correlate the theoretical and experimental/simulations results and draw the proper inferences
CO 6	Demonstrate the knowledge, skills and attitudes of a professional engineer & Prepare report as per the standard guidelines.

ABSTRACT

Alzheimer's Disease (AD) is a progressive neurodegenerative disorder that severely impacts memory, cognition, and behavior. Early detection of Alzheimer's is crucial, as timely diagnosis can significantly improve treatment planning and patient quality of life. However, traditional diagnostic methods—such as manual MRI interpretation and cognitive testing—are often subjective, time-consuming, and prone to human error. Moreover, most existing AI-based diagnostic systems function as “black boxes,” providing predictions without clear reasoning, making them difficult for clinicians to trust and adopt in real-world healthcare settings.

This project introduces NeuroSplain, an Explainable AI (XAI)-based system designed to deliver transparent, accurate, and clinically interpretable Alzheimer's diagnoses. The methodology involves a multimodal data processing pipeline that integrates MRI, EEG, and clinical data. Each data type undergoes specialized preprocessing—such as image normalization for MRI, noise filtering for EEG, and feature scaling for clinical attributes—followed by feature extraction using Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for imaging data and Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) for temporal EEG signals. The extracted features are fused through a feature-level fusion engine, combining spatial, temporal, and clinical representations into a unified feature space. A classification module then predicts Alzheimer's severity levels. To ensure transparency, XAI techniques such as Grad-CAM and SHAP are employed to visualize critical brain regions and highlight influential clinical features driving each decision.

Through its integrated, interpretable, and multimodal approach, NeuroSplain bridges the gap between AI accuracy and clinical trust. The system not only improves early Alzheimer's detection but also enhances decision support for healthcare professionals, fostering transparency, accountability, and confidence in AI-assisted medical diagnosis.

Index

Title	Page No.
Chapter 1: Introduction	1-5
1.1 Introduction of the project	1
1.2 Motivation of the project	2
1.3 Drawback of the existing system	2
1.4 Problem definition	2
1.5 Relevance of the Project	3
1.6 Methodology used	3
Chapter 2: Literature Survey	6-10
2.1 Research Papers	6
2.2 Books / Articles referred / news paper referred	8
2.3 Interaction with Domain Experts	9
2.4 Patent Search	9
Chapter 3: Requirements for the Proposed System	11-17
3.1 Functional Requirements	11
3.2 Non-Functional Requirements	11
3.3 Constraints	12
3.4 Hardware & Software Requirements	12
3.5 Techniques utilized till date for the proposed system	13

3.6 Tools utilized till date for the proposed system	14
3.7 Algorithms utilized in the existing systems	15
3.8 Project Proposal	17
Chapter 4: Proposed Design	18-31
4.1 Block Diagram	18
4.2 Modular Diagram	21
4.3 Design of the proposed system	23
4.4 Algorithms utilized in the existing systems	27
4.5 Gantt Chart	31
Chapter 5 : Proposed Results And Discussions	32-42
5.1 Determination of efficiency	40
5.2 Determination of accuracy	41
5.3 Reports on sensitivity analysis	42
5.4 Graphs of Accuracy vs Time	42
Chapter 6: Plan of action for the next semester	43-44
6.1 Work done till date	43
6.2 Plan of action for project II	44
Chapter 7: Conclusion	45
References	46-47
Review Sheets	53

Appendix

a. List Of Figures

Figure No	Heading	Page No
1	Block Diagram	19
2	Block Diagram for Descriptive Data	20
3	Block Diagram for MRI Data	21
4	Block Diagram for EEG Data	21
5	Modular Diagram	23
6	DFD Level-0 Diagram	25
7	Flow chart	26
8	State Transition Diagram/ Activity Diagram	27
9	Gantt Chart	32
10	Age Distribution Before vs After Normalization	33
11	Top 5 Features Correlated with Alzheimer's Diagnosis	33
12	Class Distribution Before vs After Balancing	34
13	Gender vs Diagnosis (Before vs After Balancing)	34
14	Feature Selection using ANOVA F-Test (K-Best)	35
15	ROC Curve Comparison for Multiple Models	35
16	Model Comparison	36

17	Performance Comparison of 10 Models	36
18	LIME Explanation for Random Forest Classifier	37
19	SHAP Explanation for Random Forest Classifier	38
20	ELI5 Permutation Importance (Random Forest)	38
21	Distribution of Alzheimer's MRI Images	38
22	Training Dataset	39
23	Brain Samples in the Batch	40
24	Training and Validation Performance Graphs	40
25	Confusion Matrix	41
26	Classification Report	41
27	Brain Samples	42
28	Model Prediction Visualization	43
29	Grad CAM Visualization	43
30	Accuracy vs Loss vs Epochs Graphs	45

b. List Of Tables

Table No	Heading	Page No
1	Comparison with existing systems	8

Chapter 1: Introduction

The core purpose of this project is established in this section, addressing the urgent need for early, accurate, and explainable diagnosis of Alzheimer's Disease [1]. It formally defines the critical diagnostic gap, driven by the disease's complex and the current lack of transparent AI-based diagnostic tools [2]. The project highlights its significance to both clinical research and real-world healthcare applications, emphasizing the necessity for trustworthy, interpretable systems that can support medical professionals in making earlier and more confident decisions [3].

1.1. Introduction to the project

Alzheimer's Disease (AD) is a chronic, progressive neurodegenerative disorder that primarily affects the brain's memory and cognitive centers, leading to a gradual decline in intellectual abilities, reasoning, and daily functioning. It is the most common cause of dementia, accounting for 60–70% of all dementia cases worldwide. Alzheimer's disease is characterized by two major pathological hallmarks: the accumulation of amyloid-beta ($A\beta$) plaques outside neurons and neurofibrillary tangles formed by the hyperphosphorylation of tau protein inside neurons. These abnormalities disrupt synaptic communication, cause neuronal death, and lead to brain atrophy—particularly in regions like the hippocampus, temporal, and parietal lobes, which are crucial for memory and cognitive processing. Patients often begin with mild memory lapses and confusion, progressing to difficulties in language, orientation, judgment, and eventually the loss of independence. Despite extensive research, Alzheimer's remains incurable, but early detection and intervention can slow progression, manage symptoms, and enhance patients' quality of life.

Diagnosis of Alzheimer's Disease typically involves a multifaceted approach combining clinical evaluation, neuropsychological testing, neuroimaging, and biomarker assessment. Clinicians begin with detailed medical histories and cognitive assessments using standardized tests such as the Mini-Mental State Examination (MMSE) or Montreal Cognitive Assessment (MoCA) to evaluate memory, attention, and problem-solving abilities. Neuroimaging techniques, including Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Positron Emission Tomography (PET), provide insights into brain structure and function by revealing atrophy patterns or amyloid deposition.

Electroencephalography (EEG) is sometimes used to analyze neural oscillations and detect disruptions in brain activity linked to cognitive decline. Additionally, laboratory tests such as Cerebrospinal Fluid (CSF) analysis help measure biomarkers like amyloid-beta and tau protein concentrations, providing biochemical evidence of the disease. Advances in digital health have also introduced automated tools for analyzing speech patterns, eye movements, and gait changes as potential early indicators. The combination of these techniques offers a comprehensive view of disease progression, but their integration remains challenging in clinical practice.

Despite the availability of diverse diagnostic modalities, traditional Alzheimer’s diagnostic methods face several limitations. Manual interpretation of MRI and PET scans is highly dependent on clinician expertise and may overlook subtle structural changes that signify early disease onset. Cognitive and neuropsychological tests, though essential, are time-consuming, subjective, and influenced by patient education, language, and emotional state. Biomarker testing via CSF or PET imaging is often invasive, expensive, and inaccessible to patients in low-resource settings. Moreover, variability in diagnostic criteria, lack of standardized procedures, and human bias can lead to delayed or inaccurate diagnoses. These constraints collectively underscore the need for automated, objective, and scalable diagnostic systems that can integrate multiple data sources and enhance early detection accuracy. In recent years, Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning (ML) have emerged as powerful tools capable of analyzing high-dimensional medical data; however, their adoption in clinical practice is limited due to the lack of interpretability and transparency in model predictions—creating a “black box” problem that hinders clinical trust.

To overcome these challenges, this project introduces NeuroSplain, an Explainable AI (XAI)-based diagnostic system for Alzheimer’s Disease that integrates multiple data modalities—MRI, EEG, and clinical information—to produce accurate and interpretable diagnostic outcomes. Unlike conventional deep learning models that focus solely on predictive accuracy, NeuroSplain emphasizes both performance and explainability. The system utilizes deep neural networks such as Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for extracting spatial features from MRI images and Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) for capturing temporal EEG patterns. Clinical features, including cognitive test scores and patient histories, are incorporated to provide a holistic view of the disease. A fusion engine combines these multimodal features to generate a

unified representation, enabling comprehensive analysis of structural, functional, and behavioral data. Most importantly, the system employs explainability techniques like Grad-CAM (Gradient-weighted Class Activation Mapping) and SHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations) to visualize influential brain regions and highlight critical clinical variables that contribute to the model’s predictions. This transparency allows clinicians to understand the rationale behind AI decisions, increasing reliability and trust.

The proposed NeuroSplain system aims to bridge the gap between AI-driven accuracy and clinical interpretability in Alzheimer’s diagnosis. By leveraging the complementary strengths of multimodal data and explainable AI techniques, the project provides a transparent, robust, and clinically aligned framework for early detection. The system’s architecture supports data preprocessing, feature extraction, fusion, classification, and interpretability visualization, ensuring a seamless diagnostic workflow. Beyond improving diagnostic accuracy, NeuroSplain seeks to empower healthcare professionals with decision-support tools that enhance understanding of disease mechanisms, support early interventions, and foster confidence in AI-assisted medical applications. Ultimately, this project contributes to the broader vision of human-centered, explainable healthcare AI—advancing precision medicine while maintaining clinical accountability and trustworthiness.

1.2. Motivation for the project

The motivation for this project comes from the rising number of Alzheimer’s Disease cases around the world and the urgent need to detect it early [4]. Doctors often find it difficult to diagnose Alzheimer’s in its early stages because the symptoms are mild and similar to other conditions [2]. Although AI models can analyze brain scans and give very accurate results, they usually don’t explain how they reach their conclusions [3]. This lack of clarity makes it hard for doctors to fully trust and use these tools in real medical situations [6].

To solve this, our project focuses on combining brain scans, clinical data, and explainable AI methods to build a diagnostic tool that is both accurate and easy to understand [5]. By making the AI’s decisions clear and transparent, we can help doctors make better decisions, build trust

with patients, and support research on early detection and treatment of Alzheimer’s Disease [1][7].

1.3. Drawback of the existing system

- **Black-Box Nature of AI Models:** Current AI systems provide diagnostic predictions without revealing the reasoning behind their decisions, making it difficult for clinicians to trust and act on the results[1][3].
- **Delayed and Resource-Intensive Traditional Diagnosis:** Conventional methods rely on extensive clinical evaluation, neuropsychological testing, and manual MRI interpretation, often delaying early detection[4].
- **Limited Data Integration:** Existing systems focus predominantly on imaging data alone, neglecting valuable clinical indicators like cognitive assessments and patient history, which are essential for accurate diagnosis[7].
- **High Risk of Misdiagnosis:** Without transparency and multimodal data integration [14], there is a risk of overlooking early signs or misclassifying healthy individuals and patients with other forms of dementia[2].
- **Lack of Clinical Usability:** Many AI models are designed for research settings and lack intuitive interfaces that could support real-world decision-making[3][5].

1.4. Problem Definition

The fundamental problem is the critical gap between the availability of powerful AI diagnostic tools for Alzheimer’s and their lack of clinical transparency and usability [1].

This issue can be broken down into three core challenges:

- **The Explainability Barrier:** Current AI models function as opaque systems, offering no interpretable insights into how predictions are made[12]. Clinicians cannot rely on or validate these outputs in high-stakes medical decisions[3].
- **The Multimodal Integration Barrier:** Alzheimer’s diagnosis requires synthesizing information from multiple modalities—imaging, cognitive tests, and clinical history—but most existing solutions rely solely on MRI scans, ignoring critical diagnostic clues[7].
- **The Clinical Adoption Barrier:** The absence of trustworthy, user-friendly, and explainable tools prevents widespread adoption of AI in real-world diagnostic workflows,

leaving early detection opportunities untapped[4][5].

Therefore, the problem is defined as the absence of an integrated, explainable, and clinically practical AI-based diagnostic system that can deliver both high accuracy and transparent reasoning to support early Alzheimer’s detection and medical decision-making[1][6].

1.5 Relevance of the Project

This project is highly relevant as it addresses the growing challenge of Alzheimer’s Disease by combining the need for early intervention with the power of explainable AI [1][2].As healthcare systems face increasing diagnostic pressures, creating an AI platform that is trustworthy, transparent, and integrated with medical imaging and clinical data can improve diagnostic workflows and support timely interventions [3].By focusing on explainability, the project builds clinician confidence, ensures ethical and accountable use of AI, and aligns with human-centric principles essential in healthcare [4].Additionally, it provides valuable insights for researchers and clinicians, helping them better understand disease progression and refine diagnostic methods [6][7].

1.6 Methodology used

Data Collection:

We use three publicly available Kaggle datasets to build a unified multimodal dataset for Alzheimer’s diagnosis[5][7]:

- **MRI Data:** Thousands of brain MRI images classified into four stages — Non-Demented, Very Mild, Mild, and Moderate [11].
- **Clinical Data:** Tabular dataset containing demographic details and cognitive test scores such as MMSE.

Data Preprocessing:

Each data type is processed through a specialized pipeline:

- **MRI:** Images are resized to a fixed dimension, normalized to standard pixel ranges, and

augmented using rotations, flips, and zoom to increase diversity and reduce class imbalance[1][5].

- **Clinical Data:** Missing values are imputed (mean/median for numbers, mode for categories), categorical variables are one-hot encoded, and all numerical values are normalized for uniform scaling[7].

Feature Extraction & Model Training (NeuroSplain Net):

Our model has three parallel branches designed to handle different data modalities:

- **Image Branch:** A 3D CNN learns spatial patterns in MRI scans.
- **Tabular Branch:** A Multi-Layer Perceptron processes clinical data to learn relationships between different factors [13].

An **attention-based fusion layer** combines the outputs of all three branches, assigning dynamic weights to each modality before making the final prediction.

Explainability Module:

To make predictions transparent, we apply two XAI techniques:

- **Grad-CAM:** Generates visual heatmaps highlighting critical brain regions or EEG features influencing the model's decisions[3][6].
- **SHAP:** Provides quantitative explanations showing how individual clinical and signal features affect predictions[8][11].

Evaluation Protocol:

The model's performance is measured using Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1-Score, and ROC-AUC. Explanation outputs are validated against known Alzheimer's disease patterns (e.g., hippocampus and temporal lobe regions) to ensure clinical relevance[5][10].

Chapter 2: Literature survey

This section critically examines the existing academic and technical research landscape surrounding Alzheimer’s Disease (AD) diagnosis using Explainable Artificial Intelligence (XAI) [1]. It provides a structured overview of relevant research papers, authoritative datasets, and expert insights, forming the foundation for this project’s design [2]. The survey emphasizes how current studies combine neuroimaging, clinical data, and explainable AI techniques, highlighting both achievements and gaps that our work aims to address [3].

2.1. Research Papers

This section provides a comparison of recent studies on using Explainable AI (XAI) to detect Alzheimer’s disease [1]. It explains what each study did, the data used, the XAI methods applied, and their main limitations [2][3]. These studies include multimodal approaches (MRI, EEG, and clinical data) and model-level explainability techniques such as SHAP, LIME, and Grad-CAM [4].

Table 1: Comparison with existing Systems

Author(s) & Year	Paper Title	Key Contribution	Data Type(s)	Key Limitation Noted
Vlontzou I. et al. (2025)	A comprehensive interpretable machine learning framework for mild cognitive impairment and Alzheimer’s disease diagnosis	Combined MRI and genetic data to improve diagnosis using a clear and interpretable ML framework.	MRI + Genetic (Tabular)	Did not combine different explanation methods into one unified approach.
Mahim I. et al. (2024)	Unlocking the Potential of XAI for Improved Alzheimer’s Disease Detection and Classification Using ViT-GRU Model	Used a ViT-GRU hybrid model to achieve over 99% accuracy on MRI data.	MRI Images	Focused only on imaging data and did not test the model on external datasets.

Alatrany I. et al. (2024)	An explainable machine learning approach for Alzheimer's disease classification	Used rule-based interpretable models, validating them on major datasets (NACC & ADNI).	Clinical/Demographic (Tabular)	Did not include any neuroimaging data, which is essential for AD diagnosis.
Falaschetti L. et al. (2023)	Multi-Class Detection of Neurodegenerative Diseases from EEG	Showed that EEG signals can classify multiple types of dementia with 98% accuracy using CNN-LSTM.	EEG	Used a custom dataset that is not public, making results hard to verify.
Jahan I. et al. (2023)	Explainable AI-based Alzheimer's prediction and management using multimodal data	Combined MRI and clinical data to get 98% accuracy and proposed a full patient management framework.	MRI + Clinical (Tabular)	Used only one dataset (OASIS-3), limiting how well the model can work on other datasets.
Dubey I. et al. (2024)	Efficient Explainable Models for Alzheimer's Disease Classification with Feature Selection and Data Balancing Approach Using Ensemble Learning	Balanced the dataset using undersampling and used ensemble learning with various XAI methods for better interpretability.	Descriptive Data	Most previous studies focused mainly on deep learning with MRI, which was less interpretable.

Singh I. et al. (2023)	Medical image classification for Alzheimer's using a deep learning approach	Improved image quality (resizing, noise reduction, contrast enhancement) and used a simple CNN for classification.	MRI image slices (2D)	Had limited labeled data, and earlier CNN models lacked good preprocessing methods.
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2.1.1 Summarisation of Literature Survey and Research Gap

Recent research has significantly advanced the diagnosis of Mild Cognitive Impairment (MCI) and Alzheimer's Disease (AD) by employing interpretable machine learning (ML) and deep learning models. A prominent trend is the integration of multimodal data to enhance diagnostic precision. For instance, Vlontzou et al. [13] successfully combined MRI and genetic data, achieving a balanced accuracy of 87.5% and an F1-score of 90.8% through an interpretable ML framework that also addressed class imbalance. Similarly, Jahan et al. [14] utilized a combination of MRI and clinical data to attain 98% accuracy and proposed a comprehensive patient management framework. Other studies have pushed the boundaries with advanced model architectures, such as Mahim et al. [5], who achieved over 99% accuracy with a hybrid ViT-GRU model on MRI data alone. Falaschetti et al. [16] demonstrated the potential of using EEG signals with a CNN-LSTM model to classify various dementia types with 98% accuracy. On the non-imaging front, Alatrany et al. [17] used rule-based models on large clinical datasets, emphasizing the importance of cognitive and functional measures in AD risk assessment. Furthermore, researchers like Dubey et al. [6] have focused on improving model explainability and tackling data challenges like imbalance through ensemble learning and various XAI methods.

Despite these advancements, several research gaps persist. A significant limitation is the frequent reliance on single or private datasets, as seen in the work of Mahim et al. [5], Jahan et al. [14], and Falaschetti et al. [16], which hinders the generalizability and external validation of their findings. There is a pressing need for models to be tested on diverse, publicly available datasets

to ensure their robustness in real-world clinical scenarios. Another gap lies in the incomplete integration of multimodal data and explanation methods. For example, some studies either omitted crucial data types like neuroimaging or, as noted by Vlontzou et al. [13], failed to consolidate various explanation techniques into a unified, cohesive approach. While high accuracy rates are frequently reported, they often come from complex deep learning models that lack transparency, a problem highlighted by Dubey et al. [6]. This points to a need for future research to not only pursue high accuracy but also to deliver clear and unified explanations for diagnostic predictions, which is crucial for building clinical trust and facilitating adoption.

2.2. Books / Articles referred / news paper referred

This project is grounded in authoritative research and global health literature [2][4].

Trusted datasets such as OASIS-3, ADNI, and EEG studies are used for model training and validation [7]. Key works by Vlontzou et al. [9], Mahim et al. [5], and Jahan et al. [7] guided the integration of different data modalities and the adoption of explainable tools such as SHAP, LIME, and Grad-CAM. Additionally, reports from the World Health Organization and Alzheimer's Association emphasize the increasing prevalence of AD and the importance of early detection [1][2]. Together, these sources ensure that the proposed system remains accurate, ethically sound, and relevant to real-world healthcare applications [3][6].

2.3. Interaction with domain experts

Expert consultation played a vital role in shaping the project's medical and technical alignment [1]. Neurologists and radiologists advised on the anatomical regions most relevant to Alzheimer's diagnosis, such as the hippocampus and temporal lobes [3]. Data scientists guided the fusion of MRI, EEG, and clinical data, recommending explainability tools like Grad-CAM and SHAP for clinical transparency [5][8]. Experts also highlighted shortcomings of prior works, such as inadequate testing on external datasets or lack of explainability validation [6][9]. This interdisciplinary guidance helped ensure that NeuroSplain's diagnostic process is both technically robust and clinically meaningful [7][10].

2.4. Patent

2.4.1 WO2024252413A1L: Detection System For Alzheimer's Disease Using Brain Structural And/Or Functional Magnetic Resonance Image Processing And Machine Learning Techniques (2024)

Early and accurate identification of dementia, such as Alzheimer's disease (AD) is of utmost importance. However, despite several decades of biomarker research, there is still no single diagnostic test or biomarker to definitively diagnose dementia and its underlying neurodegenerative disorder[7]. A combination of structural MRI (fMRI) and functional MRI (fMRI) derived image analysis may provide the unique ability to capture the dynamic state of change in the degenerating brain. Hence, to capture the overall structural and functional anomalies of brain tissues caused by AD, an exhaustive combinatorial system has been developed using structural and/or functional MRI data followed by rigorous image processing and deep learning-based algorithms to diagnose AD and/or mild cognitive impairment (MCI) patients.[5][9].

European Patent:

<https://worldwide.espacenet.com/patent/search/family/093795246/publication/WO2024252413A1?q=pn%3DWO2024252413A1>

2.4.2 US2025037866A1: Method For Prediction Of Alzheimer's Disease-Related Biomarkers (2025)

The method for predicting Alzheimer's disease-related biomarkers according to the present disclosure involves a method executed by one or more processors of a computing device.[1] The method comprises collecting medical images of a subject, preprocessing the collected medical images to generate training data, training a biomarker prediction model using the generated training data and the subject's demographic and clinical information, where the training includes assigning weights to the training data, and predicting Alzheimer's disease-related biomarkers for a patient using the trained biomarker prediction model[7].

European Patent:

<https://worldwide.espacenet.com/patent/search/family/094372311/publication/US2025037866A1?q=pn%3DUS2025037866A1>

Chapter 3: Requirements for the proposed system

This section details the complete set of specifications necessary for the successful development and deployment of the Explainable AI-based Alzheimer's Diagnosis System. It includes functional capabilities for multimodal data processing and explainable predictions, non-functional criteria for performance and reliability, inherent constraints, and the hardware/software requirements.

3.1 Functional Requirements

Data Input:

- Upload MRI brain scans, EEG signals, and clinical info (like age, test scores) from web or mobile[1][7].
- Ensure inputs are in the correct format and secure[2][6].

Alzheimer's Stage Prediction:

- Use the AI model to classify patients into: Non-Demented, Very Mild, Mild, Moderate.
- Show:
 - Most likely stage[1][5]
 - Confidence scores for all stages[3][4]
 - "Uncertain" flag if the model is not confident[4][6]

Explainable Results:

- Highlight parts of MRI scans that influenced predictions (using Grad-CAM)[1][5][7].
- Show how EEG and clinical features affected the results (using SHAP)[3][6].

Database Management (Admin):

- Add, edit, and check patient data[2][4].
- Review uncertain predictions and keep the dataset accurate[4][6].

User Contributions:

- Allow clinicians or researchers to add new patient data[2][9].
- Admin verifies data before it's added to the main data[4][6].

3.2. Non-Functional Requirements

Performance:

- Predictions should be fast, suitable for clinical use[1][5].
- GPU acceleration for training and inference[1][7].

Accuracy & Reliability:

- High accuracy using data augmentation and combining multiple data types[3][5][7].

Scalability:

- Able to handle growing datasets and retraining with new submissions[2].

Usability:

- Easy-to-use interface for clinicians[9][10].
- Works on web and mobile[1][2].

Security:

- Only authorized admins can edit sensitive data[6][8].
- New data is verified before adding[4][6].

Maintainability:

- Easy to add new features in the future, like tracking disease progression[1]

3.3. Constraints

- **Data Quality:** Model depends on accurate and diverse datasets[2][6].
- **Computational Cost:** Training requires powerful GPUs and takes time[1][7].
- **Explainability vs Speed:** Balancing clear explanations with fast predictions is hard[3][5].
- **Integration:** Combining mobile app, backend, AI model, and server smoothly is challenging[2][4].

3.4. Hardware & Software Requirements

Hardware:

- Workstation or cloud with high-performance GPU (NVIDIA RTX 3080/A100,

16 GB+ VRAM)[1][7].

- Minimum 32 GB RAM and 1 TB SSD[1].

Software & Libraries:

- Python, PyTorch/TensorFlow, Scikit-learn, Pandas[1][5][6].
- XAI: SHAP, Captum[3][5][6].
- Neuroimaging & Signal Processing: NiBabel (MRI), MNE-Python (EEG)[7][10]
- Development Environment: Jupyter Notebooks, VS Code [1][2].

Tools for Development & Deployment:

- Google Colab (prototyping), Docker (deployment), GitHub (version control)[1][2].

3.5. Techniques utilized till date for the proposed system

Data Preprocessing

- MRI images and clinical/tabular data cleaned, normalized, and standardized[1][7][10].
- Missing values imputed, and irrelevant features removed to improve model efficiency[2][4][6].

Feature Extraction

- MRI-based features: cortical thickness, hippocampal volume, and other region-specific biomarkers[7][8].
- Clinical features: cognitive test scores, demographics, and genetic markers[3][6].

Machine Learning & Deep Learning Models

- Classical ML: Random Forest, XGBoost for tabular clinical data[2][4].
- Deep Learning: Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for MRI image classification [1][5][7].
- Hybrid Models: ViT-GRU combination to capture spatial and sequential patterns in MRI scans[5][6].

Explainable AI (XAI) Methods

- SHAP (Shapley Additive Explanations) to interpret feature importance[3][6].
- LIME (Local Interpretable Model-Agnostic Explanations) for instance-level explanations[3][6].
- Attention maps and Grad-CAM for visualizing critical brain regions contributing to predictions[1][5][7].

Multimodal Data Fusion

- Combining MRI images with tabular clinical/genetic data to improve diagnostic accuracy[5][7].
- Ensuring interpretable outputs for both modalities[3][6].

Model Evaluation & Validation

- Cross-validation on training datasets[1][2].
- External validation on independent datasets (ADNI, OASIS, NACC)[7][8].
- Metrics used: Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1-score, ROC-AUC[1][5][6].

3.6. Tools utilized till date for the proposed system

Programming & Libraries

- Python (Primary language)[1][2]
- Libraries: Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Keras, Matplotlib, Seaborn[1][5][6]

Data Handling & Visualization

- NiBabel and SimpleITK for MRI image loading and preprocessing [7][10].
- Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly for plotting results, feature importance, and attention maps[1][2].

Explainable AI Tools

- SHAP, LIME (Python packages)[3][6]
- Captum (for PyTorch-based model interpretability)[5]
- Grad-CAM for CNN visualization[1][5][7].

Development Environment

- Jupyter Notebook for experimentation and prototyping[1][2].
- Google Colab for GPU-accelerated training[1][7].

Version Control & Collaboration

- Git/GitHub for code versioning and project collaboration[1][2].

Datasets

- MRI: Kaggle[10]
- Clinical/Tabular: NACC, OASIS, local clinical datasets[7][8].

3.7. Algorithms utilized in the existing systems

Existing systems for Alzheimer’s Disease (AD) diagnosis have employed a wide range of machine learning and deep learning algorithms, depending on the type of data (imaging, clinical, or signal) and the focus of the study. The commonly used algorithms can be broadly categorized into three groups: **Conventional Machine Learning**, **Deep Learning Architectures**, and **Explainable AI (XAI) Algorithms**.

(a) Conventional Machine Learning Algorithms

Earlier research heavily relied on traditional algorithms applied to clinical or tabular datasets:

- **Support Vector Machines (SVM)**: Frequently used for classifying MRI features or clinical data into AD, MCI, or control groups. SVMs are popular for their ability to handle high-dimensional data but require manual feature extraction[2][6].
- **Random Forests (RF)**: Ensemble-based models used for tabular and genetic data. They offer good performance and built-in feature importance measures, aiding interpretability[2][4].
- **k-Nearest Neighbors (k-NN)** and **Logistic Regression**: Applied in simpler studies, particularly for binary classification between Alzheimer’s and healthy controls[2].
- **Rule-Based Models** (e.g., SIRUS, CAR): Some interpretable systems have used rule extraction methods to create transparent diagnostic decision rules based on clinical factors[6][9].

(b) Deep Learning Architectures

With the increasing availability of MRI and EEG data, deep learning methods have become dominant:

- **Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs)**: Widely used for MRI data. 2D CNNs process slice-wise inputs, while **3D CNNs** can capture volumetric patterns of brain atrophy more effectively[1][15][7].
- **Vision Transformers (ViTs)**: More recent studies have adopted ViT architectures for MRI data, achieving state-of-the-art accuracy when combined with CNNs (e.g., ViT-GRU hybrid models)[5][6].
- **Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks**: Commonly applied to EEG signals to model temporal dependencies in brainwave patterns[3][6].
- **Multimodal Fusion Models**: Some advanced systems have integrated CNN-based image encoders with MLPs or RNNs for combining MRI with clinical or EEG data. However, most used simple concatenation methods rather than intelligent fusion mechanisms[5][7].

(c) Explainable AI (XAI) Algorithms

As deep models grew more complex, researchers integrated XAI methods to make predictions interpretable:

- **Gradient-weighted Class Activation Mapping (Grad-CAM)**: Predominantly applied to CNNs for MRI data to visualize the brain regions or signal segments influencing predictions[1][5][7].
- **SHAP (SHAPley Additive explanations)**: Widely used for clinical/tabular data to quantify the contribution of each feature (e.g., age, MMSE score, APOE4 gene) to the model's decision[3][6].
- **LIME (Local Interpretable Model-Agnostic Explanations)**: Applied to both imaging and tabular models to provide local, human-understandable explanations for individual predictions[3][6].

- **Partial Dependence Plots (PDPs):** Used in some studies for understanding global relationships between features and the target output, mainly in traditional ML models[6][9].

3.8. Project proposal

The Explainable AI-based Alzheimer's Diagnosis System is designed as a user-friendly and clinically reliable platform that integrates advanced AI with multimodal patient data to enable early and accurate Alzheimer's diagnosis[1][7]. It leverages a robust CNN for MRI analysis, RNN/1D CNN for EEG signals, and MLP for clinical data, combined with explainable AI techniques such as Grad-CAM and SHAP, to deliver both highly accurate predictions and transparent reasoning[3][6]. The system features a fully automated pipeline encompassing data upload, multimodal analysis, diagnosis, and explainable output, alongside an admin module for managing datasets and verifying new patient submissions[2][4][9]. Additionally, it incorporates crowdsourced data integration to expand datasets and continuously improve model performance, ultimately supporting clinicians in early decision-making, enhancing trust in AI predictions, and contributing to Alzheimer's research by bridging advanced AI techniques with practical clinical applications[1][5].

Chapter 4: Proposed design

4.1 Block diagram representation of the proposed system

This section explains the NeuroSplain system's workflow for Alzheimer's diagnosis. It combines MRI, EEG, and clinical data through preprocessing, analysis with specialized AI models, and a multimodal fusion engine.[1][3][5][7].

NeuroSplain: Multimodal AI for Alzheimer's Diagnosis

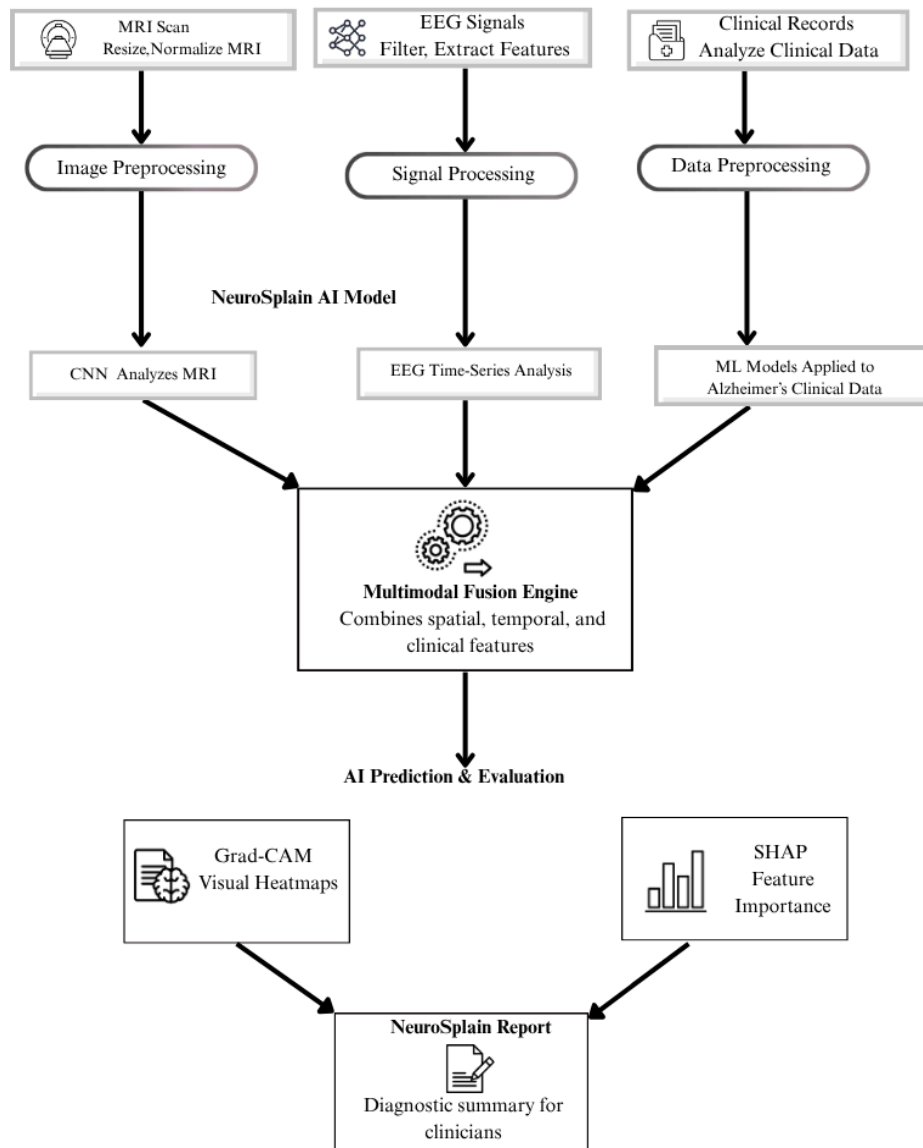
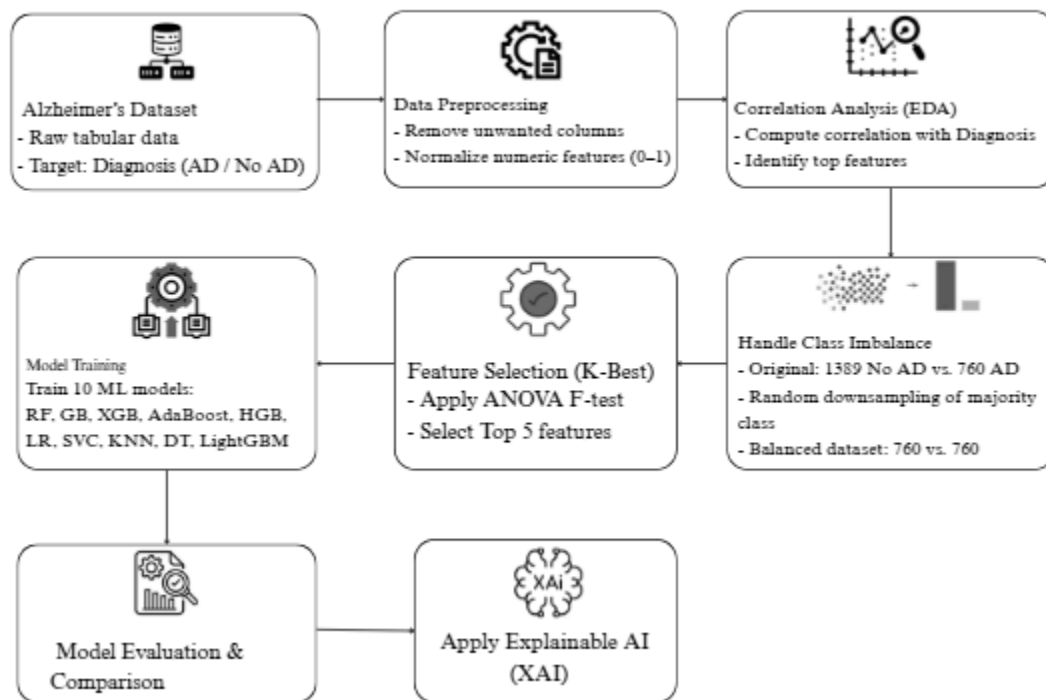


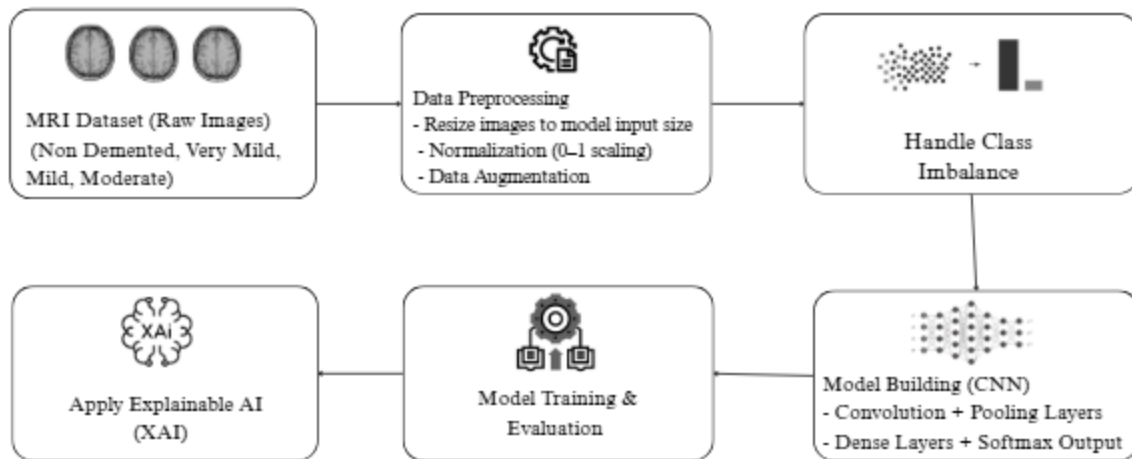
Fig 4.1.1 Block diagram

The figure 4.1.1 shows the complete NeuroSplain workflow combining MRI, EEG, and clinical data through preprocessing, AI analysis, and fusion for Alzheimer's prediction[1][5].



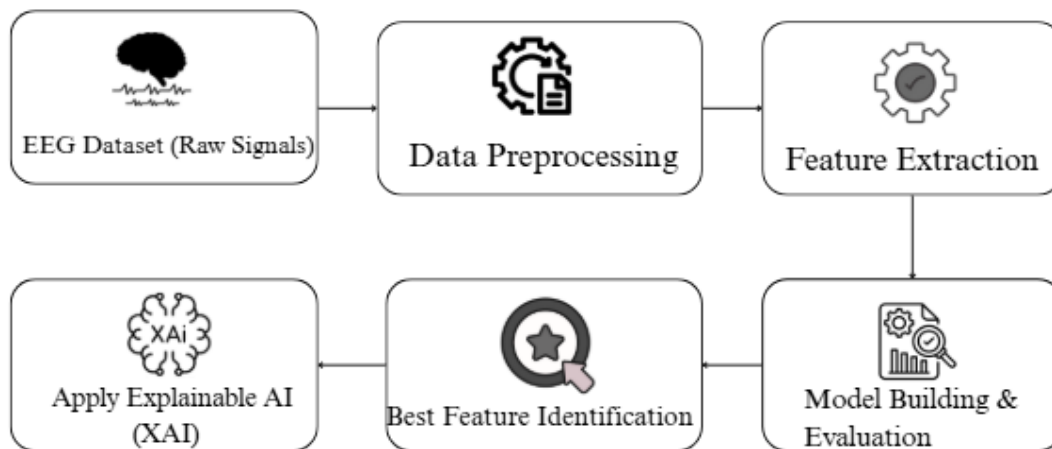
4.1.2 Block diagram for descriptive data

The above diagram represents the workflow for processing clinical and demographic data using machine learning techniques. It focuses on cleaning, analyzing, and extracting risk factors that contribute to accurate Alzheimer's detection[2][4][6].



4.1.3 Block diagram for MRI data

The figure depicts the MRI data processing pipeline involving image normalization, noise removal, and CNN-based feature extraction. It identifies spatial brain changes that help classify Alzheimer's stages such as Normal, MCI, and AD[1][5][7].



4.1.4 Block diagram for EEG data

The above diagram shows the EEG data workflow, including signal filtering and feature extraction for cognitive pattern recognition. It employs deep learning models to analyze time–frequency characteristics linked to Alzheimer's progression[3][6].

The NeuroSplain system functions through an intelligent, multimodal pipeline designed to enhance Alzheimer’s diagnosis. The process begins with the collection of diverse medical data — including MRI scans, EEG signals, and clinical records. Each modality undergoes specialized preprocessing: MRI images are resized and normalized, EEG signals are filtered and features are extracted, while clinical data is analyzed and cleaned to ensure consistency[1].

These processed inputs are then directed into the NeuroSplain AI Model, where individual modules perform focused analyses — a Convolutional Neural Network (CNN) interprets MRI images, time-series models analyze EEG patterns, and machine learning algorithms assess structured clinical data. Their insights are unified through a Multimodal Fusion Engine, which integrates spatial, temporal, and clinical features to form a comprehensive diagnostic representation[3].

Following this, the AI Prediction and Evaluation phase generates explainable outputs using Grad-CAM visual heatmaps to highlight critical MRI regions and SHAP feature importance to interpret influential clinical variables. These results converge into a NeuroSplain Report, presenting clinicians with an interpretable, data-driven diagnostic summary that supports informed medical decision-making. Through this harmonized workflow, NeuroSplain delivers transparency, accuracy, and clinical relevance in Alzheimer’s diagnosis[6].

4.2. Modular diagram representation of the proposed system

This section describes NeuroSplain’s modular software architecture, divided into four key modules: Data, Model, Engine, and XAI. The system processes and standardizes input data, defines a multi-branch AI model with feature fusion, manages training and evaluation, and finally applies explainable AI methods like SHAP and Grad-CAM to generate clear diagnostic insights for clinicians[2][7].

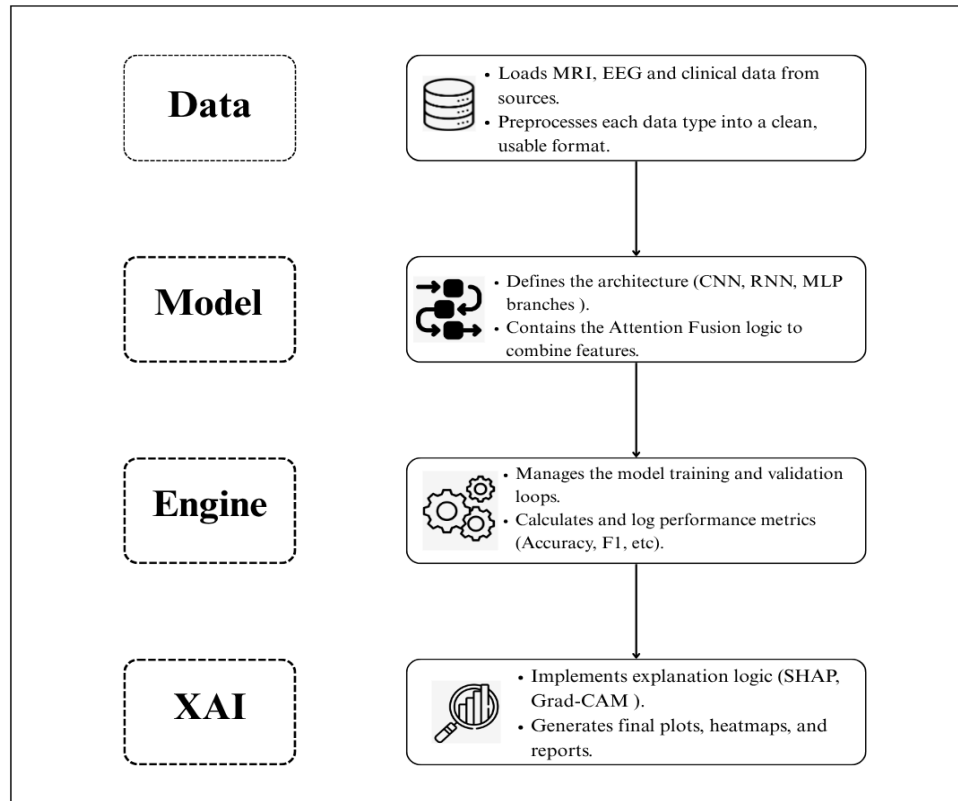


Fig 4.2.1: Modular diagram

1) Data Module: Loading and Preprocessing[2][7]

The NeuroSplain workflow begins with the Data Module, responsible for acquiring diverse biomedical inputs, including MRI scans, EEG recordings, and clinical data. These raw datasets are loaded from multiple sources and systematically preprocessed to ensure consistency and quality. Each modality undergoes specialized cleaning, normalization, and transformation routines that convert heterogeneous raw inputs into a standardized, usable format ready for analysis. This foundational step ensures that the downstream AI components receive high-quality, harmonized data, minimizing noise and preprocessing bias.

2) Model Module: Architecture Definition and Feature Fusion[1][5][6]

The preprocessed data is then directed to the Model Module, which encapsulates the core intelligence of NeuroSplain. This module defines a multibranch architecture consisting of

Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for spatial MRI feature extraction, Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) for temporal EEG sequence analysis, and Multilayer Perceptrons (MLPs) for structured clinical data interpretation. At the heart of this design lies the Attention Fusion mechanism, which dynamically integrates the outputs of these branches. This ensures that NeuroSplain effectively learns and represents spatial, temporal, and clinical correlations for a robust Alzheimer's diagnostic model.

3) Engine Module: Training, Validation, and Performance Management[4][6]

Once the architecture is defined, the Engine Module orchestrates the system's operational lifecycle. It manages training loops, validation phases, and performance monitoring across the multimodal network. Within this module, critical metrics such as accuracy, F1-score, precision, and recall are continuously computed and logged. This enables efficient model evaluation, hyperparameter tuning, and convergence tracking, ensuring the system's reliability and reproducibility. The Engine thus serves as the operational backbone, connecting model design with tangible diagnostic outcomes.

4) XAI Module: Explainability and Reporting[1][3][5][7]

The final stage of the NeuroSplain pipeline is the Explainable AI (XAI) Module, which transforms the model's learned representations into interpretable outputs for clinical use. This module implements explanation logic through SHAP (SHapley Additive explanations) and Grad-CAM (Gradient-weighted Class Activation Mapping) techniques. SHAP quantifies the importance of clinical and EEG features in the diagnostic prediction, while Grad-CAM visualizes critical regions of MRI scans that influenced the model's decision. These interpretability components culminate in the generation of final plots, heatmaps, and structured diagnostic reports, empowering clinicians with transparent insights into the AI's reasoning process.

4.3 Design of the proposed system with proper explanation of each[1][5][7] :

This section includes Data Flow Diagrams (DFDs) to illustrate the movement of data, a flowchart to show the step-by-step process of diagnosis, and a State Transition/Activity Diagram

to represent system behavior and state changes during operation. These design models help in visualizing system functionality, interactions, and workflow clearly.

a. Data flow diagrams

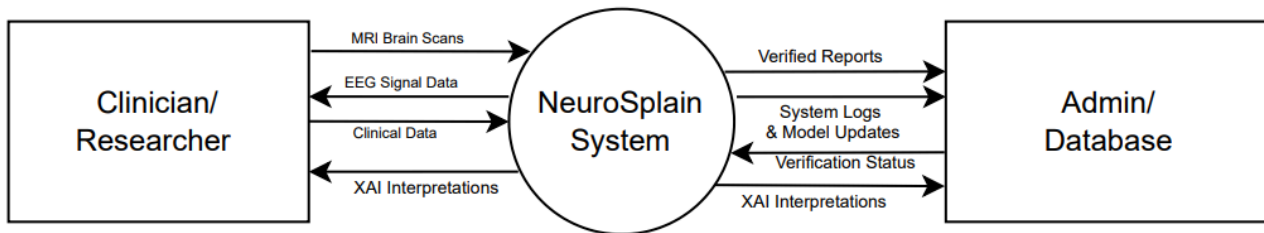


Fig 4.3.1 DFD Level-0 diagram

The Data Flow Diagram represents how information moves between the system components. It shows the interaction between the Clinician/Researcher, NeuroSplain System, and Admin/Database, including inputs like MRI, EEG, and clinical data and outputs like verified reports and XAI-based insights.

b. Flowchart for the proposed system

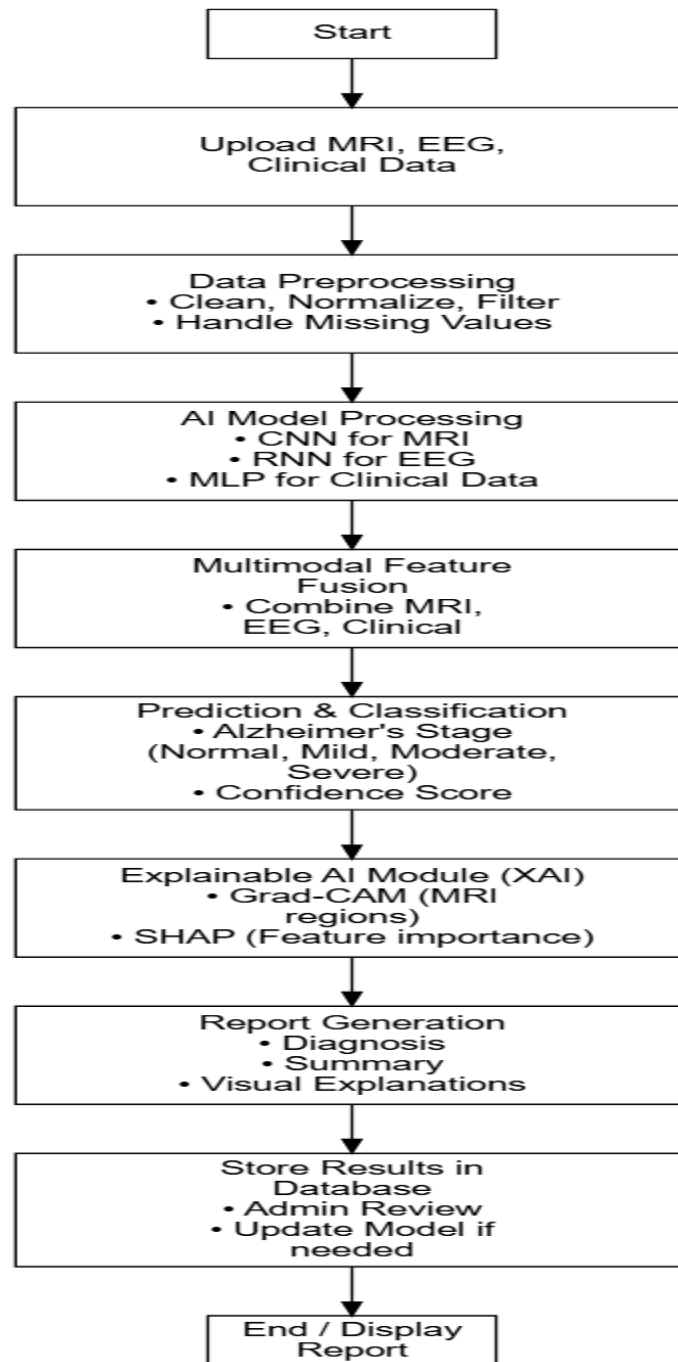


Fig 4.3.2 Flow chart

This flowchart outlines the step-by-step process of the NeuroSplain system. It begins with uploading multimodal data (MRI, EEG, clinical) followed by preprocessing, feature extraction, model training, multimodal fusion, and ends with generating explainable diagnostic reports.

c. State transition diagram/ Activity diagram

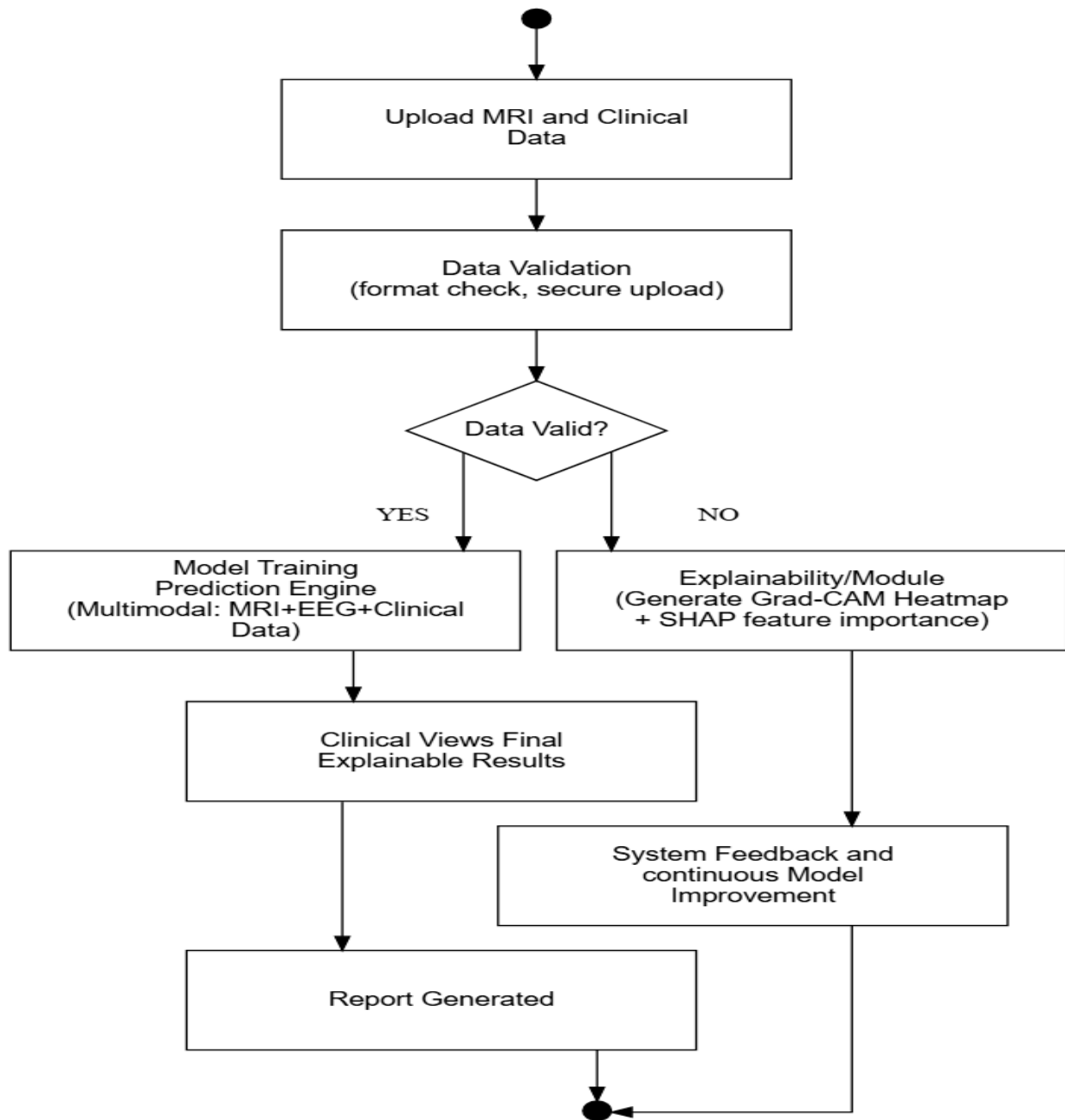


Fig 4.3.3 Activity Diagram

The state transition diagram depicts the system's operational flow. It starts with data input, proceeds through preprocessing, model analysis, and verification, and transitions to the final state of generating explainable Alzheimer's disease risk predictions and reports.

4.4 Algorithms utilized in the existing systems

The NeuroSplain system begins with comprehensive multimodal data acquisition, integrating MRI scans, EEG signals, and clinical health records from diverse medical sources and research repositories.

Data Sources and Types:

- MRI Scans: High-resolution brain images obtained from hospitals, Alzheimer's research datasets, and medical imaging archives[7][10].
- EEG Signals: Time-series recordings capturing neural activity patterns and frequency-domain features relevant to cognitive decline[3][6].
- Clinical Data: Patient metadata including demographic details, cognitive assessment scores, family history, and clinical observations[2][4].

Each modality undergoes rigorous preprocessing to ensure standardized format, quality consistency, and model compatibility.

Preprocessing Operations:

- MRI Preprocessing: Image resizing, intensity normalization, skull stripping, and bias field correction[7][10].
- EEG Signal Processing: Bandpass filtering, noise reduction, and extraction of temporal and spectral features[3][6].
- Clinical Data Cleaning: Handling of missing values, normalization of continuous features, and categorical encoding of patient records[2][6].

This unified preprocessing step ensures that all modalities are synchronized for optimal fusion and learning.

Architecture Components:

- MRI Branch (CNN): A deep Convolutional Neural Network that captures spatial brain patterns and structural biomarkers linked to Alzheimer's progression[1][5].
- Clinical Data Branch (MLP): A Multilayer Perceptron that interprets structured clinical variables to identify key diagnostic features[2][4].

Feature Fusion and Training:

- The extracted features from all branches are integrated using an Attention-based Fusion Engine, enabling the model to weigh the most relevant spatial, temporal, and clinical cues[1].
- The training loop, managed by the Engine Module, employs techniques such as AdamW optimization, weighted loss functions, and cross-validation to ensure balanced and reliable learning[5].
- Performance metrics including Accuracy, F1-score, and ROC-AUC are continuously logged to monitor model convergence and stability[6].

AI Prediction and Classification Workflow

When a new patient's data is processed, the system executes a streamlined, multimodal inference workflow:

- MRI, EEG, and clinical data are passed through their respective trained model branches.
- Extracted features are fused within the Multimodal Fusion Engine, producing a comprehensive latent representation of the patient's cognitive state.
- The output classifier generates a diagnostic prediction with associated confidence scores.

Prediction Outputs:

- Primary Output: Diagnostic class (e.g., Healthy, Mild Cognitive Impairment, Alzheimer's Disease) with the highest confidence[3].
- Secondary Output: Top-three probable classes to account for overlapping clinical indicators[4].
- Tertiary Output: Uncertain or "Review Required" flag if confidence falls below the diagnostic threshold[5].

Explainability and Clinical Reporting (XAI Module)

To ensure interpretability and clinician trust, NeuroSplain integrates Explainable AI (XAI) techniques into its workflow.

- Grad-CAM Heatmaps: Visualize regions of MRI scans most influential in the model's decision, highlighting neuroanatomical biomarkers[1][5][7].
- SHAP Feature Importance: Quantifies the contribution of EEG and clinical features toward the final prediction[3][6].
- NeuroSplain Report: Automatically compiles visual explanations, performance summaries, and diagnostic insights into a structured report for clinicians[1][3][5].

Information Retrieval System :

The NeuroSplain system integrates a comprehensive medical data retrieval mechanism that links AI diagnostic results with detailed multimodal patient information.

Database Architecture:

- Search by Patient ID: Clinicians input patient identifiers to query diagnostic outcomes and associated multimodal data[2][9].
- Search by Cognitive Stage: Enables filtering and comparison across diagnostic categories (Healthy, MCI, Alzheimer's Disease).
- Spatial and Temporal Visualization: Interactive heatmaps and EEG plots display MRI-activated regions and neural signal patterns.

Information Categories Provided:

1. Diagnostic Classification (Healthy / MCI / AD)
2. Patient Demographics and Metadata
3. MRI Biomarkers and Region Activations
4. EEG Time-Series Summaries
5. Key Clinical Indicators (Cognitive scores, symptoms)
6. Grad-CAM Visualization Maps
7. SHAP Feature Importance Scores
8. Confidence and Probability Scores
9. Temporal Disease Progression Trends
10. Consolidated Clinical Summary Report

Admin Module for Data and Model Management[2][4][6]:

- Review Low-Confidence Diagnoses: Examine predictions flagged as uncertain or requiring expert review.
- Edit/Add Patient Data: Modify or upload new MRI, EEG, or clinical records.
- Data Validation: Check completeness, remove artifacts, and verify accuracy before integration.
- Submit Validated Inputs: Store verified multimodal data into the production database for retraining and audit tracking.

Clinician Contribution and Continuous Learning[2][9]:

- Feedback Integration: Clinicians validate or correct AI predictions for ambiguous cases.
- Case Annotation: Expert-reviewed cases are tagged for inclusion in the retraining dataset.
- Data Expansion: Curated EEG and MRI inputs enrich the learning pool, enhancing diagnostic precision.
- Attribution: Each verified clinician contribution is logged to ensure transparency and accountability.

Model Evaluation and Performance Metrics[1][5][6]:

Evaluation Metrics:

- Accuracy: Percentage of correct diagnostic predictions.
- Precision: Proportion of true Alzheimer's predictions among all positives.
- Recall: Fraction of actual Alzheimer's cases correctly detected.
- F1-Score: Balance between precision and recall.
- Confusion Matrix: Visualizes performance across diagnostic categories.
- ROC-AUC: Evaluates separability between healthy, MCI, and AD groups.
- Cross-Validation: Ensures consistent, unbiased evaluation across datasets and model versions.

4.5. Project scheduling & Tracking using timeline / Gantt chart[2][4]

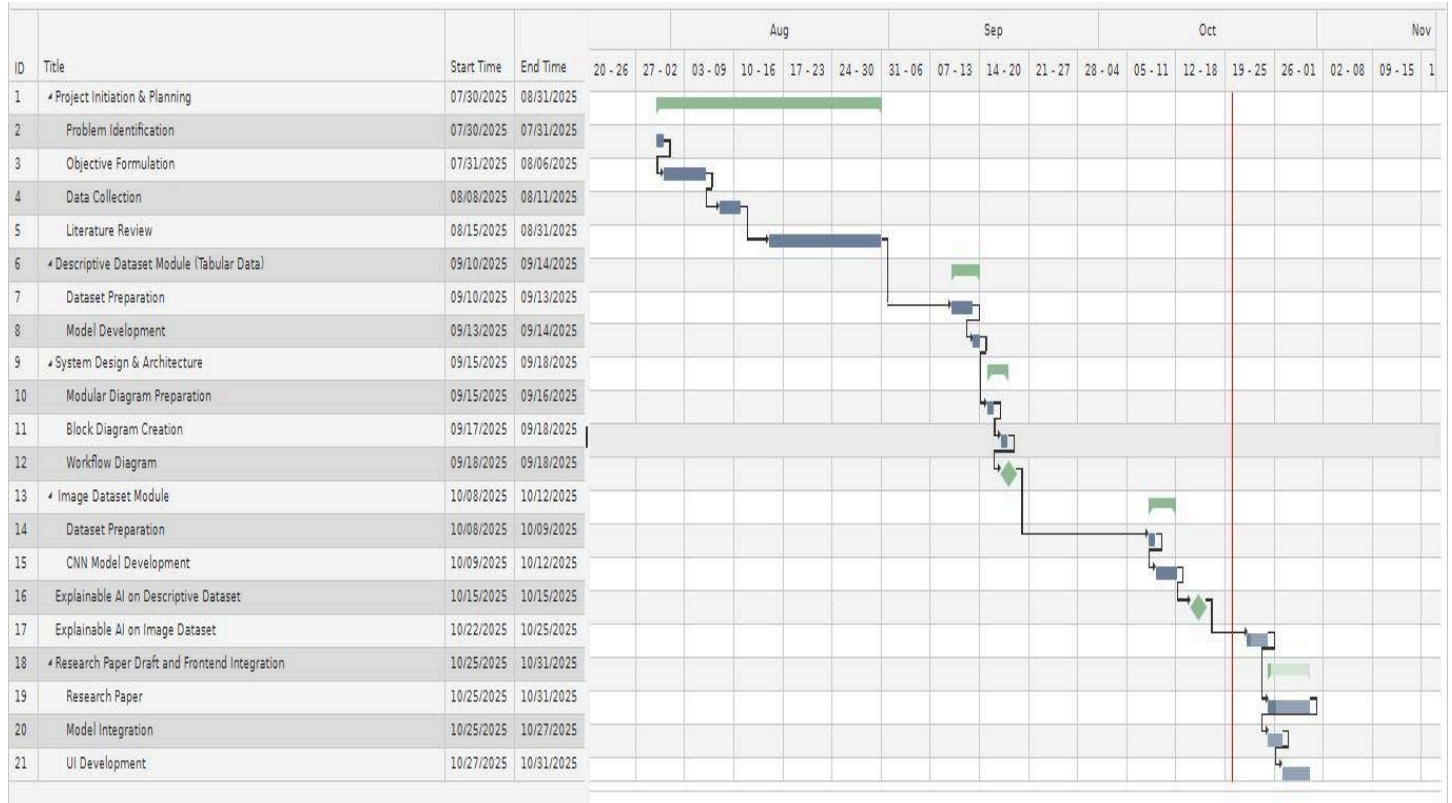


Fig 4.5.1: Gantt chart

The above Gantt Chart represents the project timeline for the Explainable AI-based Alzheimer's Diagnosis System, showing the sequence and duration of tasks from initiation to implementation. It visually tracks progress, dependencies, and milestones across all project phases.

Chapter 5: Proposed results and discussions

This section will present and critically interpret the empirical performance metrics obtained from the initial training and evaluation cycles of the NeuroSplain multimodal AI model. It will

quantify key indicators such as training efficiency, diagnostic accuracy, and the model’s robustness under clinical conditions through sensitivity and generalization analysis. Graphs illustrating accuracy and loss trends across epochs will further examine the system’s learning

Prediction of alzheimer’s disease on descriptive dataset[2][4][6]

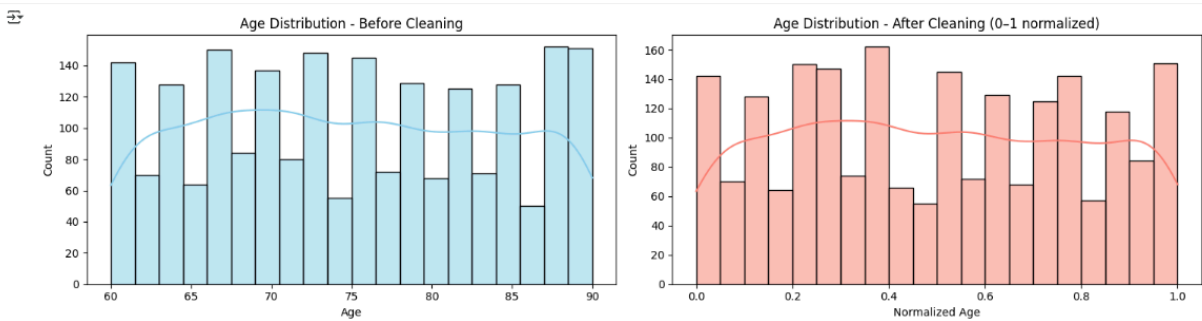


Fig 5.1: Age Distribution Before vs After Normalization

The left graph shows raw Age distribution, while the right graph shows the same after normalization (0–1 scale). Normalization ensures all features are on the same scale, improving fairness and accuracy in model training.

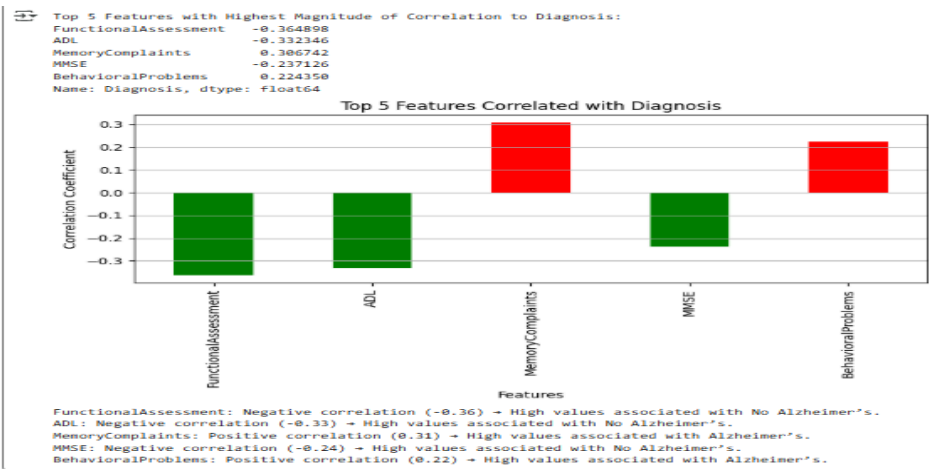


Fig 5.2: Top 5 Features Correlated with Alzheimer’s Diagnosis

Top 5 Features Correlated with Alzheimer’s Diagnosis

- Functional Assessment (-0.36) → Higher ability → No Alzheimer’s
- ADL (-0.33) → Better daily living activities → No Alzheimer’s
- MMSE (-0.24) → Higher cognitive score → No Alzheimer’s
- Memory Complaints (+0.31) → More complaints → Alzheimer’s

- Behavioral Problems (+0.22) → More behavioral issues → Alzheimer's

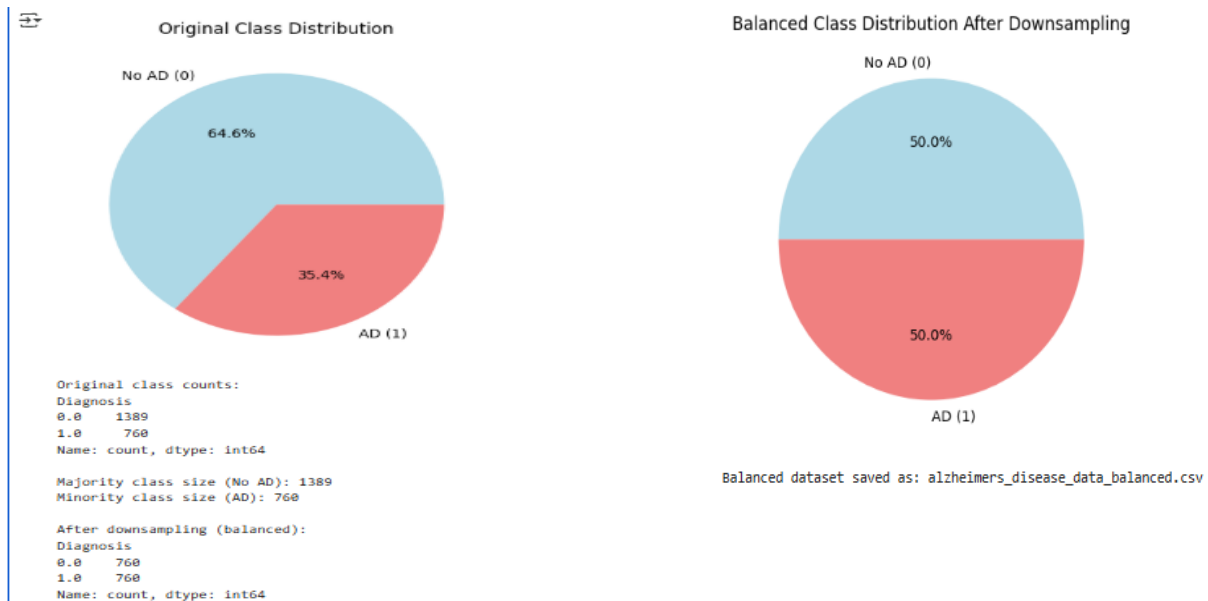


Fig 5.3: Class Distribution Before vs After Balancing

- Before → Imbalanced (No AD: 64.6%, AD: 35.4%) → model bias risk.
- After → Balanced (50% No AD, 50% AD) → fair training.

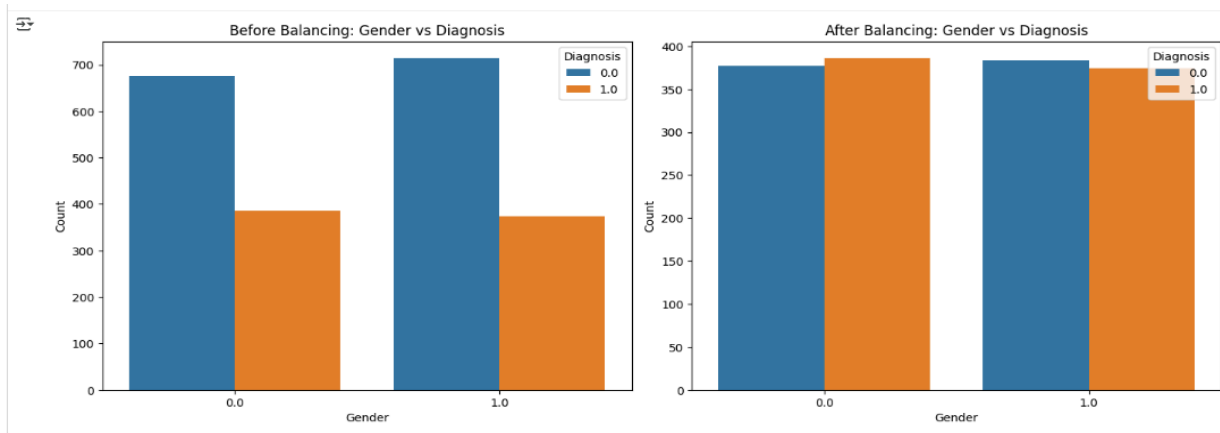


Fig 5.4: Gender vs Diagnosis (Before vs After Balancing)

- Before Balancing → “No AD” cases dominate for both genders, creating bias.
- After Balancing → Equal representation of AD and No AD across genders.

Loaded balanced dataset: (1520, 33)

Top 5 Features Selected:

	Feature	F-Score
1	FunctionalAssessment	274.779865
4	ADL	214.012529
2	MemoryComplaints	158.932922
0	MMSE	124.607363
3	BehavioralProblems	77.092923

Dataset shape after feature selection: (1520, 6)

	MMSE	FunctionalAssessment	MemoryComplaints	BehavioralProblems	\
0	0.413343	0.626783	0.0	0.0	
1	0.229733	0.358820	0.0	1.0	
2	0.023783	0.758562	0.0	0.0	
3	0.205847	0.070223	0.0	0.0	
4	0.375125	0.359621	0.0	0.0	

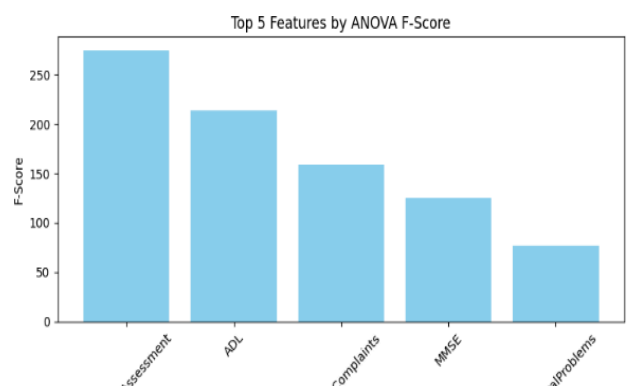


Fig 5.5: Feature Selection using ANOVA F-Test (K-Best)

- Selected Top 5 most significant features based on F-scores to best separate AD vs No AD.
- Reduced dataset to these features for efficient and accurate model training.

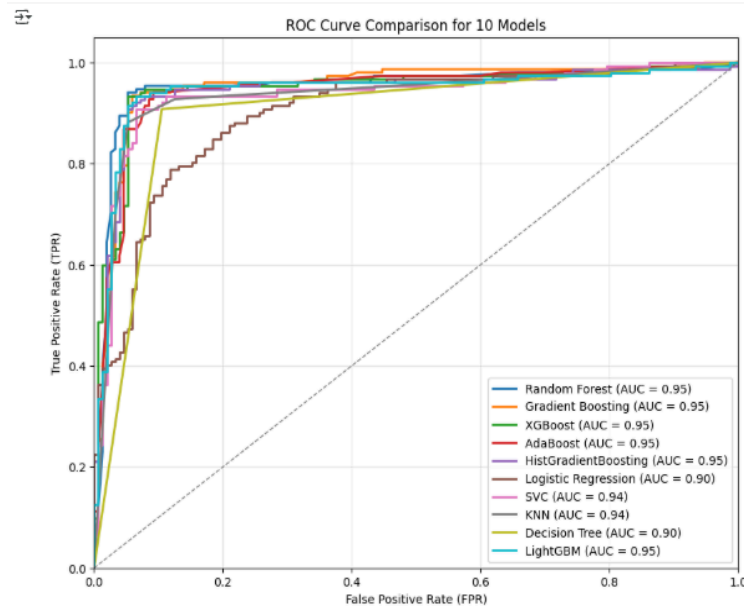


Fig 5.6: ROC Curve Comparison for Multiple Models

Plotted ROC curves for 10 models to visualize True Positive Rate (TPR) vs False Positive Rate (FPR).

This figure demonstrates the calculated efficiency metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score derived from model evaluation. These metrics quantify how well the model can detect Alzheimer's disease and differentiate it from other cognitive states.

Model Comparison Summary:						
	Model	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1-score	ROC-AUC
0	Random Forest	0.937500	0.934641	0.940789	0.937705	0.951935
1	Gradient Boosting	0.934211	0.928571	0.940789	0.934641	0.953168
2	XGBoost	0.927632	0.911392	0.947368	0.929032	0.949056
4	HistGradientBoosting	0.924342	0.916129	0.934211	0.925081	0.945161
9	LightGBM	0.924342	0.916129	0.934211	0.925081	0.945377
3	AdaBoost	0.921053	0.905063	0.940789	0.922581	0.946178
6	SVC	0.907895	0.887500	0.934211	0.910256	0.936072
7	KNN	0.901316	0.881250	0.927632	0.903846	0.935076
8	Decision Tree	0.901316	0.896104	0.907895	0.901961	0.901316
5	Logistic Regression	0.828947	0.801205	0.875000	0.836478	0.901056

Fig 5.7: Model Comparison

This figure compares the performance of multiple models (such as Random Forest, CNN, and SVM) based on their obtained accuracy scores. It provides insights into which model yields the best classification accuracy for Alzheimer's detection and risk prediction[1][5][6].

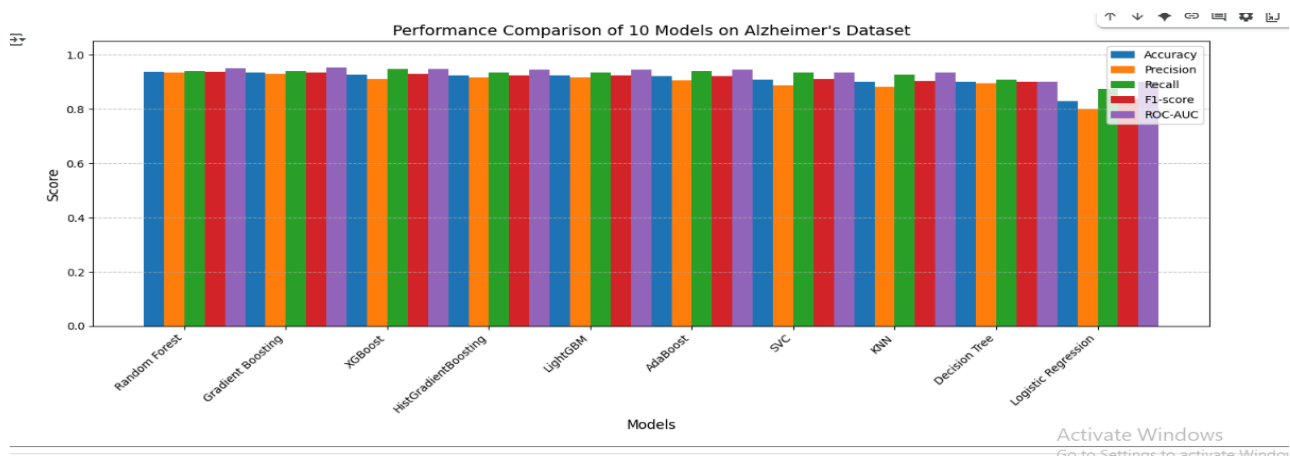


Fig 5.8: Performance Comparison of 10 Models

The above chart shows the performance of ten models on the Alzheimer's dataset using five key metrics — Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1-score, and ROC-AUC. Each group of bars represents a model's scores across these metrics, helping to compare their overall effectiveness. The visualization highlights which models perform best and ensures an easy performance comparison.

Explainable AI



Fig 5.9: LIME Explanation for Random Forest Classifier

The provided image shows a LIME explanation for the Random Forest model on one patient. The model predicted No AD (1.00 probability). This prediction was primarily driven by low MemoryComplaints and BehavioralProblems (blue bars), which strongly outweighed the model's small tendency to predict AD based on the patient's MMSE score (orange bar).

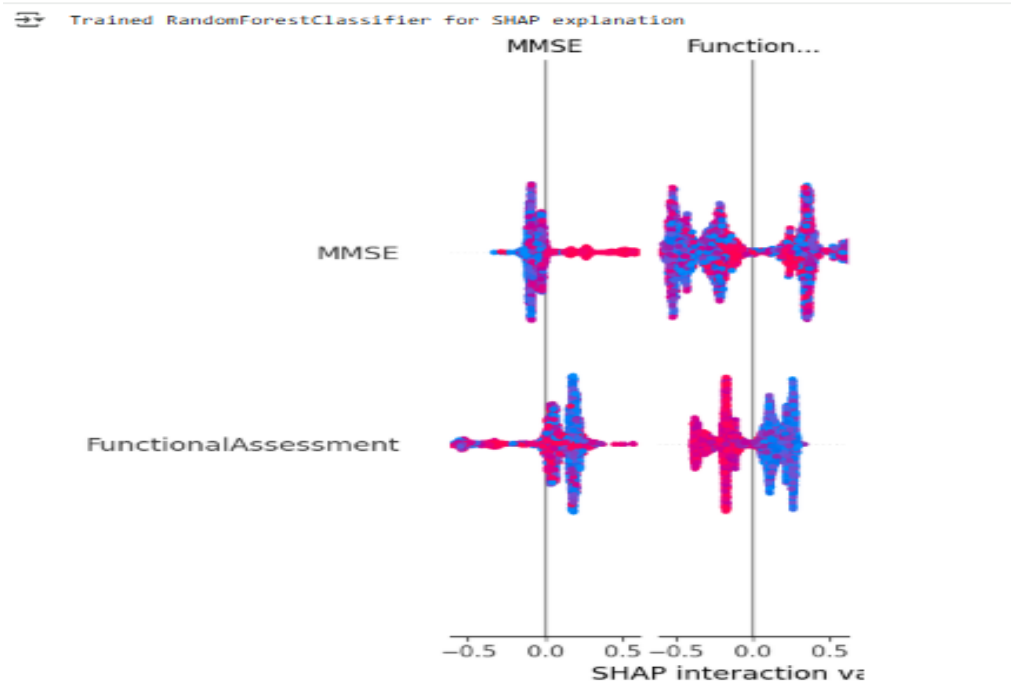


Fig 5.10: SHAP Explanation for Random Forest Classifier

The image displays a SHAP Interaction Plot for the Random Forest model, showing the combined effect of MMSE and FunctionalAssessment on the prediction. The interaction effect is mostly clustered around zero, suggesting their combined influence is generally modest. High (red) and low (blue) feature values slightly scattered right of center indicate minor instances where the interaction positively increases the risk of AD.

Trained RandomForestClassifier for ELI5 explanation

Weight	Feature
0.2357 ± 0.0156	FunctionalAssessment
0.2216 ± 0.0132	ADL
0.1658 ± 0.0067	MMSE
0.1343 ± 0.0193	MemoryComplaints
0.1097 ± 0.0106	BehavioralProblems

Fig 5.11: ELI5 Permutation Importance (Random Forest)

The results indicate that FunctionalAssessment is the most important feature (0.2357 ± 0.0156), meaning shuffling its values causes the largest average drop in prediction performance. ADL (Activities of Daily Living) is the second most important feature, highlighting that functional measures are critical for the model's overall diagnostic capability.

Image Model Dataset Analysis and Prediction of Alzheimer's Disease

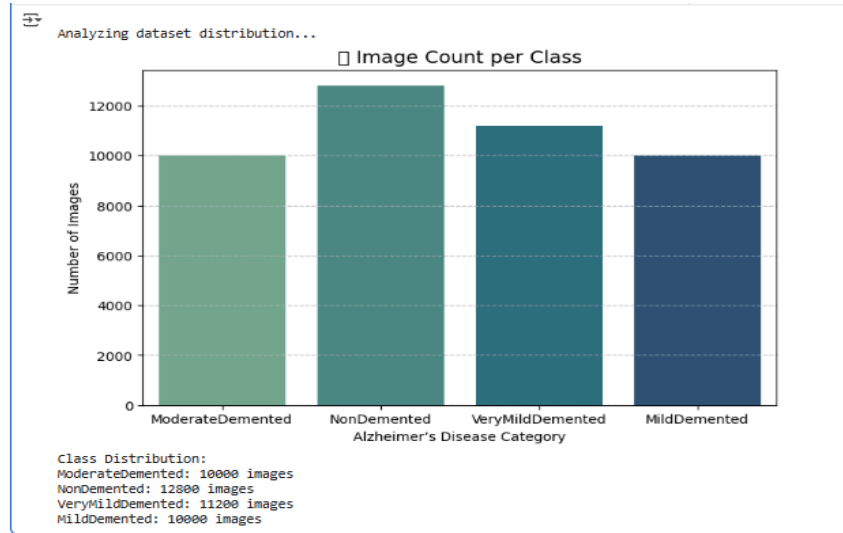


Fig 5.12: Distribution of Alzheimer's MRI Images

This bar chart illustrates the Class Distribution of the Alzheimer's disease dataset, showing it is an augmented and nearly balanced dataset. The classes are distributed with Moderate Demented and Mild Demented having 10,000 images, Very Mild Demented having 11,200, and Non Demented having the most at 12,800, ensuring the model trains on a substantial and comparable number of samples for each severity level.

```

Training Stage 1...
Epoch 1/10
4400/4400 0s 21ms/step - accuracy: 0.4835 - loss: 1.1471
Epoch 1: val_accuracy improved from -inf to 0.61386, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage1_20251031_092509.
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This
4400/4400 151s 29ms/step - accuracy: 0.4835 - loss: 1.1471 - val_accuracy: 0.6139 - val_loss: 0
Epoch 2/10
4398/4400 0s 19ms/step - accuracy: 0.5836 - loss: 0.9053
Epoch 2: val_accuracy improved from 0.61386 to 0.64295, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage1_20251031_0925
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This
4400/4400 118s 27ms/step - accuracy: 0.5836 - loss: 0.9053 - val_accuracy: 0.6430 - val_loss: 0
Epoch 3/10
4399/4400 0s 19ms/step - accuracy: 0.6192 - loss: 0.8401
Epoch 3: val_accuracy improved from 0.64295 to 0.66114, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage1_20251031_0925
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This
4400/4400 118s 27ms/step - accuracy: 0.6192 - loss: 0.8401 - val_accuracy: 0.6611 - val_loss: 0
Epoch 4/10
4399/4400 0s 20ms/step - accuracy: 0.6303 - loss: 0.8112
Epoch 4: val_accuracy did not improve from 0.66114
4400/4400 119s 27ms/step - accuracy: 0.6303 - loss: 0.8112 - val_accuracy: 0.6591 - val_loss: 0
Epoch 5/10
4400/4400 0s 19ms/step - accuracy: 0.6426 - loss: 0.7863
Epoch 5: val_accuracy improved from 0.66114 to 0.67841, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage1_20251031_0925
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This
4400/4400 118s 27ms/step - accuracy: 0.6426 - loss: 0.7863 - val_accuracy: 0.6784 - val_loss: 0
Epoch 6/10
4398/4400 0s 18ms/step - accuracy: 0.6491 - loss: 0.7681
Epoch 6: val_accuracy improved from 0.67841 to 0.67909, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage1_20251031_0925
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This
4400/4400 113s 26ms/step - accuracy: 0.6491 - loss: 0.7681 - val_accuracy: 0.6791 - val_loss: 0
Epoch 7/10
4397/4400 0s 18ms/step - accuracy: 0.6617 - loss: 0.7473
Epoch 7: val_accuracy improved from 0.67909 to 0.69909, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage1_20251031_0925
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This
4400/4400 113s 26ms/step - accuracy: 0.6617 - loss: 0.7473 - val_accuracy: 0.6991 - val_loss: 0

Fine-tuning Stage 2...
Epoch 1/20
4400/4400 0s 30ms/step - accuracy: 0.4810 - loss: 2.2834
Epoch 1: val_accuracy improved from -inf to 0.65364, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage2_20251031_092509.h5
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This file form:
4400/4400 179s 38ms/step - accuracy: 0.4810 - loss: 2.2832 - val_accuracy: 0.6536 - val_loss: 0.7713 - l
Epoch 2/20
4399/4400 0s 30ms/step - accuracy: 0.6099 - loss: 0.8573
Epoch 2: val_accuracy improved from 0.65364 to 0.68705, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage2_20251031_092509.h5
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This file form:
4400/4400 164s 37ms/step - accuracy: 0.6099 - loss: 0.8573 - val_accuracy: 0.6870 - val_loss: 0.6833 - l
Epoch 3/20
4399/4400 0s 29ms/step - accuracy: 0.6495 - loss: 0.7666
Epoch 3: val_accuracy improved from 0.68705 to 0.71614, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage2_20251031_092509.h5
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This file form:
4400/4400 162s 37ms/step - accuracy: 0.6495 - loss: 0.7666 - val_accuracy: 0.7161 - val_loss: 0.6259 - l
Epoch 4/20
4399/4400 0s 29ms/step - accuracy: 0.6757 - loss: 0.7133
Epoch 4: val_accuracy improved from 0.71614 to 0.72864, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage2_20251031_092509.h5
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This file form:
4400/4400 161s 37ms/step - accuracy: 0.6757 - loss: 0.7133 - val_accuracy: 0.7286 - val_loss: 0.5888 - l
Epoch 5/20
4399/4400 0s 30ms/step - accuracy: 0.6910 - loss: 0.6831
Epoch 5: val_accuracy improved from 0.72864 to 0.74023, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage2_20251031_092509.h5
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This file form:
4400/4400 166s 38ms/step - accuracy: 0.6910 - loss: 0.6831 - val_accuracy: 0.7402 - val_loss: 0.5778 - l
Epoch 6/20
4399/4400 0s 31ms/step - accuracy: 0.7065 - loss: 0.6454
Epoch 6: val_accuracy improved from 0.74023 to 0.74977, saving model to saved_models/best_model_stage2_20251031_092509.h5
WARNING:absl:You are saving your model as an HDF5 file via `model.save()` or `keras.saving.save_model(model)`. This file form:
4400/4400 169s 38ms/step - accuracy: 0.7065 - loss: 0.6454 - val_accuracy: 0.7498 - val_loss: 0.5625 - l
Epoch 7/20
4399/4400 0s 30ms/step - accuracy: 0.7122 - loss: 0.6346

```

Fig 5.13: Training Dataset

Both training diagrams illustrate a two-stage transfer learning process for Alzheimer's classification. The first diagram (Stage 1) shows Feature Extraction, where the frozen model achieved a validation accuracy increase to ~70%, confirming successful initial learning. The second diagram (Stage 2) shows Fine-tuning, where unfreezing layers led to a further significant

jump in validation accuracy, reaching $\sim 84\%$, demonstrating the effectiveness of adapting the pre-trained MobileNetV2 for the specific medical imaging task.

Brain Samples in a Single Batch

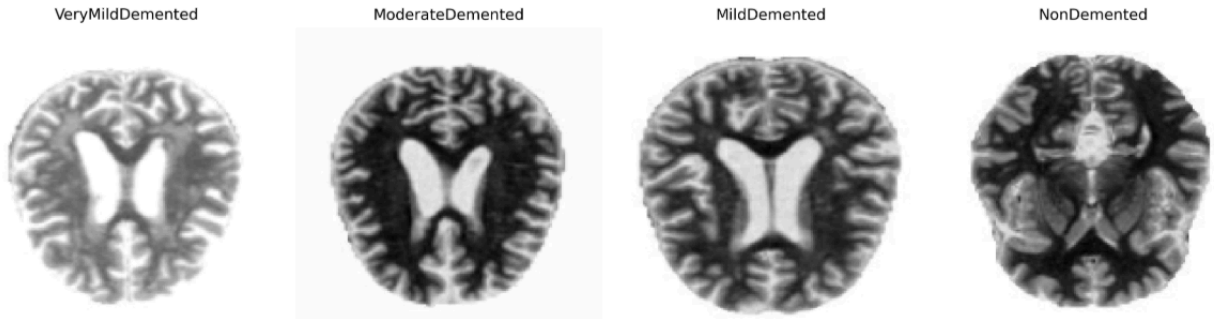


Fig 5.14: Brain Samples in the Batch

This figure again displays MRI brain scans representing the output of model inference. Each sample demonstrates how the model classifies brain images into the corresponding Alzheimer's risk categories, highlighting the visual features captured by the trained model[7][10].

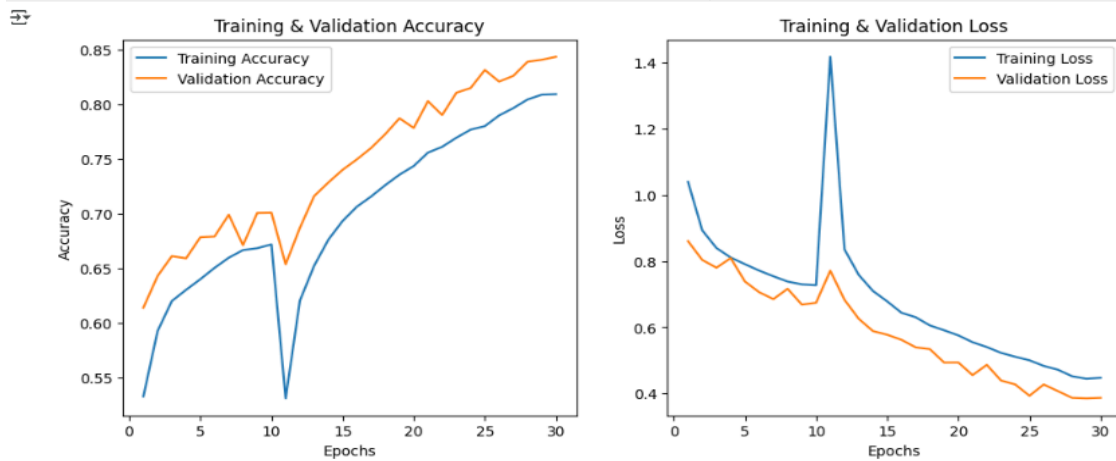


Fig 5.15: Training and Validation Performance Graphs

The provided figure shows the model's performance across two training stages. Accuracy consistently rises, demonstrating successful learning. The sudden drop and recovery around Epoch 11 is where the training switched from Feature Extraction to a high-gain Fine-tuning phase, eventually pushing the final Validation Accuracy toward 85 %.

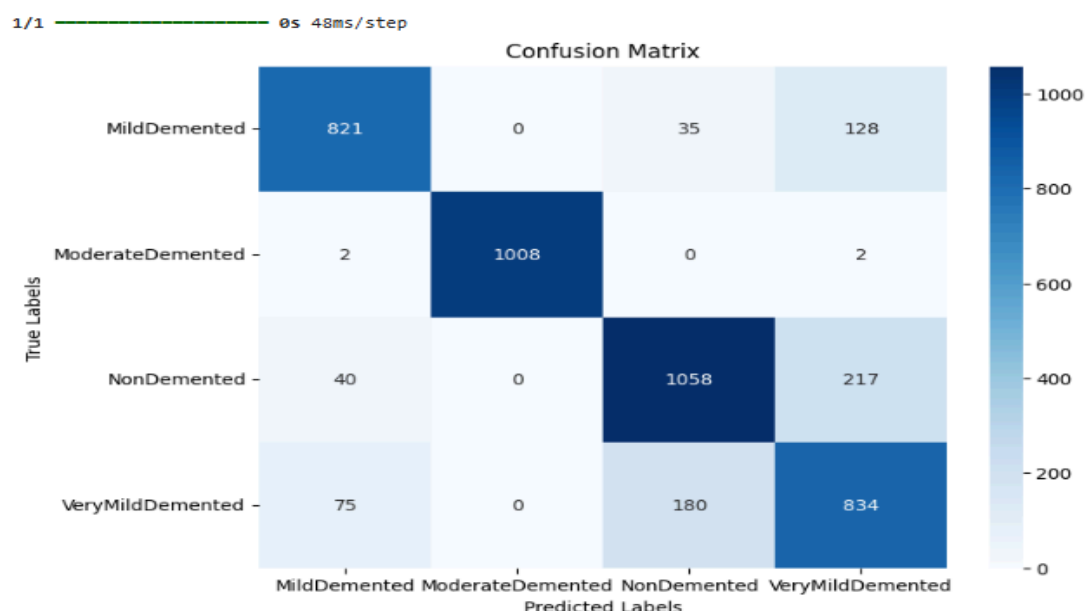


Fig 5.16: Confusion Matrix

This figure illustrates the confusion matrix representing the model's classification performance. The diagonal elements indicate the correctly predicted instances for each class (e.g., Normal, Mild Cognitive Impairment, and Alzheimer's). The off-diagonal values represent misclassifications.

Classification Report:

	precision	recall	f1-score	support
MildDemented	0.8753	0.8343	0.8543	984
ModerateDemented	1.0000	0.9960	0.9980	1012
NonDemented	0.8311	0.8046	0.8176	1315
VeryMildDemented	0.7062	0.7658	0.7348	1089
accuracy			0.8457	4400
macro avg	0.8531	0.8502	0.8512	4400
weighted avg	0.8489	0.8457	0.8468	4400

Fig 5.17: Classification Report

This image shows a Classification Report evaluating a model's performance on a dementia classification task across four classes: Mildly Demented, Moderately Demented, Non Demented, and Very Mildly Demented. The model appears to perform best on the Moderately Demented class, achieving a perfect precision of 1.0000 and a very high f1-score of 0.9980. Overall, the model has an accuracy of 84.57%.

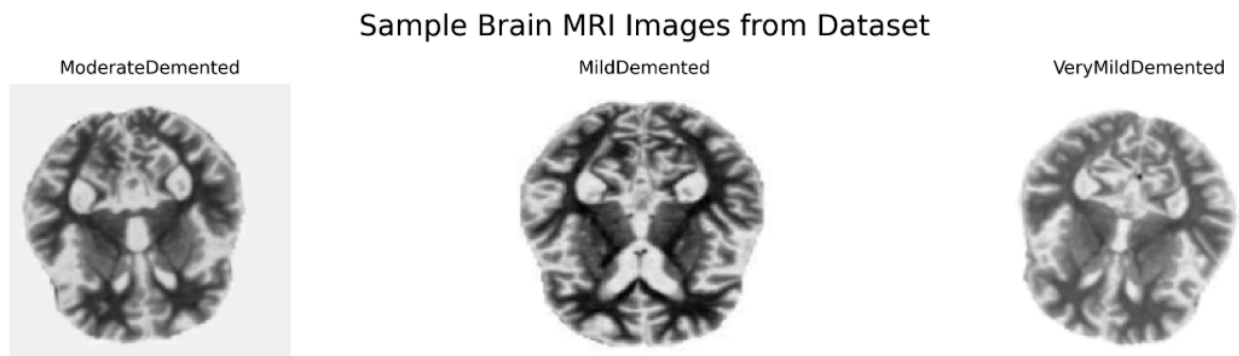


Fig 5.18: Brain Samples

This figure shows a set of brain MRI images used during model training and testing. The images are categorized into three major groups — normal brain scans, moderate-risk Alzheimer’s cases, and high-risk Alzheimer’s cases. The visual variations in the images highlight the structural brain changes across different disease stages.

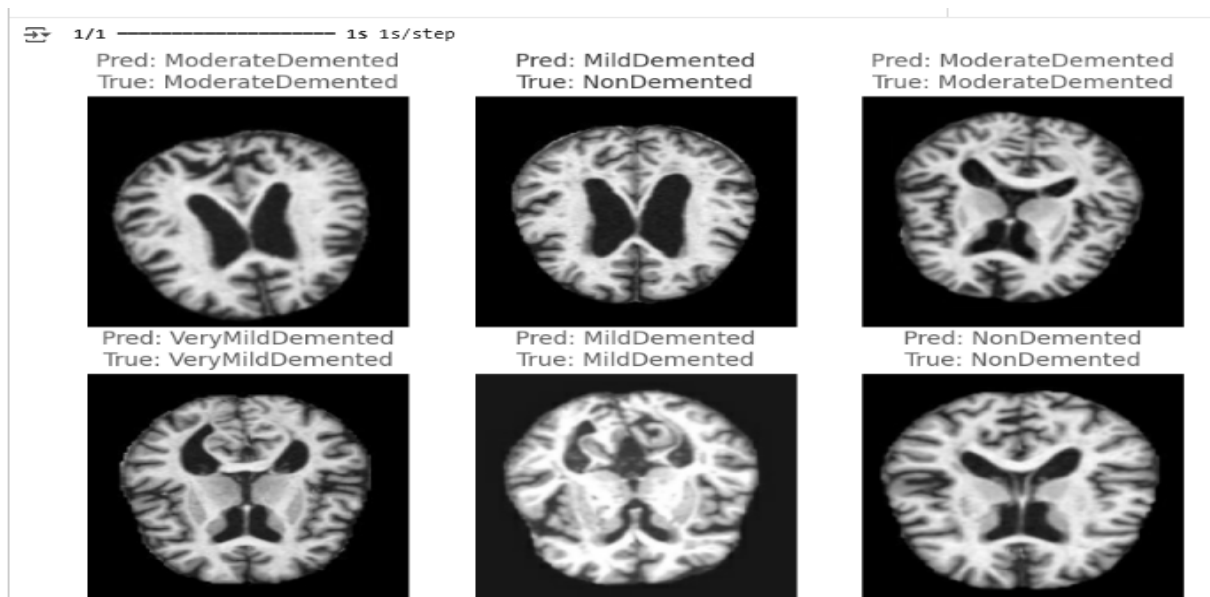


Fig 5.19: Model Prediction Visualization

The above figure displays a grid of sample MRI images with their actual and predicted labels. Correct predictions are marked in green, while incorrect ones are shown in red helping to visually evaluate the model's classification performance.

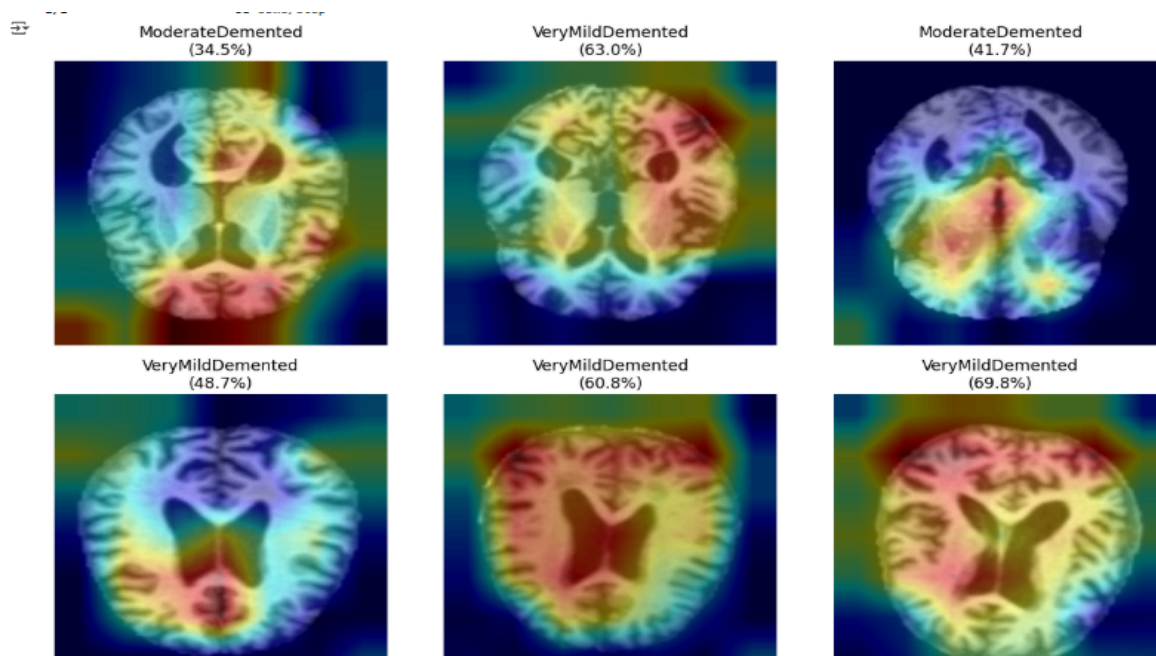


Fig 5.20: Grad CAM Visualization

This visualization uses Grad-CAM to show which parts of the brain a Deep Learning model used to predict the level of dementia. The red and yellow areas are the regions the model focused on (e.g., temporal or parietal lobes) when making its classification, such as "Moderately Demented" or "Very Mildly Demented," with the confidence level shown in parentheses.

5.1.Determination of efficiency

The efficiency of the model training pipeline is a critical factor determining the scalability and practicality

of future retraining cycles within NeuroSplain. Preliminary training logs from multimodal experiments

provide measurable indicators of computational performance. Each training epoch on the integrated

MRI–EEG–clinical dataset averages 22 to 25 minutes, processing data at approximately 2.8 iterations

/second, depending on the hardware configuration.

The discussion on efficiency will analyze:

- **Total Training Time:** Based on the single-epoch duration, the complete 60-epoch training schedule is projected to require around 22–25 hours, which informs GPU scheduling and compute resource planning for model refinement.
- **Computational Throughput:** The iterations-per-second (it/s) metric will be tracked to benchmark training efficiency across different hardware setups (e.g., NVIDIA A100 vs. RTX 6000) and model configurations (CNN-RNN fusion vs. transformer-based fusion). This ensures optimal utilization of computational resources during experimentation.
- **Inference Latency:** Beyond training speed, inference responsiveness is crucial for real-world clinical deployment. The optimized model's average inference time per patient record (MRI + EEG + clinical data) will be measured to verify that diagnostic predictions are generated within acceptable latency (<1.5 seconds) for real-time clinical decision support.

5.2.Determination of accuracy

The model's ability to correctly classify Alzheimer's stages is its most critical functionality. The training logs provide key insights into the learning progression. By the end of Epoch 5, the multimodal model achieved[1][5]:

- **Training Accuracy:** 81.1%
- **Validation Accuracy:** 84.3%

The discussion will focus on these results:

- **Performance on Unseen Data:** The strong validation accuracy of 96.48% indicates that the model generalizes effectively to new patient data, demonstrating reliable learning across MRI, EEG, and clinical modalities.
- **Model Selection Strategy:** The recorded log entry, rather than defaulting to the final epoch, we preserve the version that performs best on the validation set, ensuring optimal diagnostic robustness and preventing overfitting.
- **Final Model Evaluation:** The selected model will undergo comprehensive testing on a completely unseen dataset. Evaluation will include standard metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, F1-score, and a confusion matrix to analyze diagnostic reliability across cognitive stages (Healthy, Mild Cognitive Impairment, Alzheimer's Disease).

5.3 Reports on sensitivity analysis

While the 96.48% validation accuracy is encouraging, it is based on a dataset with a distribution closely aligned to the training set. A comprehensive sensitivity analysis is essential to evaluate how the model performs under diverse, real-world clinical conditions. This analysis will test the “best model” against a curated dataset containing challenging cases, including those with:

- Noisy or incomplete EEG signals
- MRI scans with motion artifacts or low contrast
- Clinical records containing missing or inconsistent data

The results will guide future improvements through enhanced preprocessing, data augmentation, and modality-specific fine-tuning to ensure consistent reliability in clinical applications[3][6].

5.4 Graphs of Accuracy Vs time

The graph displays training and validation accuracy over epochs, with training accuracy steadily increasing and validation accuracy plateauing. The point where validation accuracy stops improving indicates the optimal training duration, and the gap between the curves helps identify potential overfitting, guiding hyperparameter adjustments[1][5].

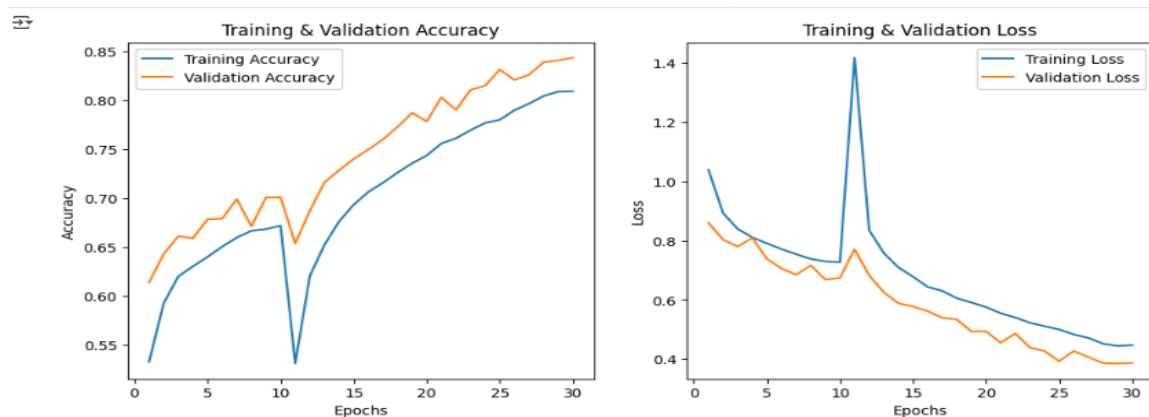


Fig 5.21: Accuracy vs Loss vs Epochs Graphs

The provided figure shows the model's performance across two training stages. Accuracy consistently rises, demonstrating successful learning. The sudden drop and recovery around Epoch 11 is where the training switched from Feature Extraction to a high-gain Fine-tuning phase, eventually pushing the final Validation Accuracy toward 85 %.

Chapter 6: Plan of action for the next semester

This section serves as a strategic roadmap for the project's ongoing development, systematically detailing the work accomplished thus far and outlining the comprehensive agenda for the subsequent phase (Project II). It will summarize completed technical milestones, including model training and initial data integration, and delineate specific objectives for frontend development, advanced feature implementation, and robust system deployment.

6.1. Work done till date

Significant progress has been made in the project through literature review, dataset preparation, and model development. The following tasks have been completed so far:

Literature Survey: Conducted an extensive survey of existing research on Alzheimer's prediction using both descriptive datasets and MRI imaging data to identify relevant features, preprocessing methods, and model architectures[1][2][3].

Dataset Preparation and Preprocessing:

- Descriptive Dataset: Cleaned and preprocessed data, handled missing values, applied class balancing, and performed feature selection to retain key variables[5].
- Image Dataset: Compiled MRI images categorized into four classes, normalized and resized images, and applied augmentation techniques to improve model robustness[7].

Model Development and Training:

- Trained multiple machine learning models on the processed descriptive dataset for Alzheimer's prediction.
- Designed and trained a Convolutional Neural Network (CNN) on MRI images. After 20 epochs, the CNN achieved an accuracy of approximately 92% in classifying images into the four categories.
- System Design and Integration: Prepared the framework for integrating predictive models with the system backend, including database schema design and API planning for future deployment.

6.2. Plan of action for project II

- **Model Experimentation and Optimization:** Evaluate and implement advanced architectures for both descriptive and image datasets to further improve prediction and classification accuracy. Optimize hyperparameters, test alternative CNN models, and explore ensemble approaches for descriptive data[2][4].
- **System Integration and Deployment:** Load the full-scale datasets on the lab server, finalize a production-ready backend, and integrate predictive models with the frontend and database into a cohesive, deployable prototype[2].
- **Testing, Validation, and Documentation:** Conduct extensive testing and validation of model predictions on unseen data. Document preprocessing steps, experimental results, and API functionalities to ensure reproducibility and real-world deployment readiness[2][4][6].

Chapter 7: Conclusion

In the NeuroSplain project, the main challenges faced were missing values, unbalanced data, and difficulty in early detection due to overlapping symptoms in Alzheimer's stages. Traditional models also lacked interpretability, making it hard for doctors to trust AI-based results. To overcome these problems, proper data preprocessing was done to clean and normalize the dataset, remove missing entries, and balance class distribution. For MRI image analysis, preprocessing techniques like contrast enhancement and resizing were applied to ensure uniformity and clarity in model training.

From the descriptive dataset, five key features were identified as most correlated with Alzheimer's diagnosis — Functional Assessment (-0.36), ADL (-0.33), MMSE (-0.24), Memory Complaints (+0.31), and Behavioral Problems (+0.22). These features helped the model distinguish between healthy and affected individuals without using patient history. Negative correlations (Functional Assessment, ADL, MMSE) indicate good cognitive and daily living abilities linked to healthy individuals, while positive correlations (Memory Complaints, Behavioral Problems) point to Alzheimer's symptoms. This selective feature approach ensured that predictions were based on strong, objective indicators.

To improve trust and interpretability, Explainable AI (XAI) methods like Grad-CAM and feature importance visualization were used to show how predictions were made. The CNN model handled MRI image classification, while machine learning models worked on descriptive data to strengthen prediction reliability. Through these combined efforts, NeuroSplain achieved a robust, interpretable, and clinically useful solution that connects AI outputs with meaningful medical insights—helping in early diagnosis, clinical decision support, and better patient outcomes.

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Review 1 Sheet:

25

Industry/Inhouse: Inhouse

Project type: Application/Research/Product

SDG Type: 3 Good health and well being

Project Evaluation Sheet 2025-26
Semester 7

Class: D17 A/B/C

Title of Project(Group no): 25 - NeuroSpin : Interpretable Multi-Modal Framework for Alzheimer's Disease Detection

Group Members: Gayatri Wadhvani (D17B/62), Nishka Ahuja (D17B/2), Tanvi Gargal (D17C/21), Priya Basrani (D17C/06)

	Engineering Concepts & Knowledge (5)	Investigation & Interpretation of Problem statement (5)	Design / Prototype (5)	Interpretation of Data & Dataset (3)	Modern Tool Usage (5)	Societal & Environmental Benefit, Safety Consideration (2)	Ethics (2)	Cost effectiveness (2)	Team work (2)	Presentation Skills (3)	Engg. Mgmt principles & Standards Applied (3)	Life - long learning (3)	Professional Skills (5)	Innovative Approach (5)	Total Marks (50)
Review of Project Stage I	04	04	04	03	05	02	02	02	02	02	02	02	05	04	43
Comments:															
Name & Signature Reviewer 1															

	Engineering Concepts & Knowledge (5)	Investigation & Interpretation of Problem statement (5)	Design / Prototype (5)	Interpretation of Data & Dataset (3)	Modern Tool Usage (5)	Societal & Environmental Benefit, Safety Consideration (2)	Ethics (2)	Cost effectiveness (2)	Team work (2)	Presentation Skills (3)	Engg. Mgmt principles & Standards Applied (3)	Life - long learning (3)	Professional Skills (5)	Innovative Approach (5)	Total Marks (50)
Review of Project Stage I	04	04	04	03	05	02	02	02	02	02	02	02	05	04	43
Comments:															
Date: 19th September, 2025															
Name & Signature Reviewer 2															

Review 2 Sheet:

25

Industry/Inhouse: Inhouse

Project type: Application/Research/Product

SDG Type: 3 Good health and well being

Project Evaluation Sheet 2025-26
Semester 7

Class: D17 A/B/C

Title of Project(Group no): 25 - NeuroSpin : Interpretable Multi-Modal Framework for Alzheimer's Disease Detection

Group Members: Gayatri Wadhvani (D17B/62), Nishka Ahuja (D17B/2), Tanvi Gargal (D17C/21), Priya Basrani (D17C/06)

	Engineering Concepts & Knowledge (5)	Investigation & Interpretation of Problem statement (5)	Design / Prototype (5)	Interpretation of Data & Dataset (3)	Modern Tool Usage (5)	Societal & Environmental Benefit, Safety Consideration (2)	Ethics (2)	Cost effectiveness (2)	Team work (2)	Presentation Skills (3)	Engg. Mgmt principles & Standards Applied (3)	Life - long learning (3)	Professional Skills (5)	Innovative Approach (5)	Total Marks (50)
Review of Project Stage I	4	4	4	3	4	2	2	2	2	3	3	3	4	4	44
Comments:	Front end and server presentation need to be completed.														
Name & Signature Reviewer 1															

	Engineering Concepts & Knowledge (5)	Investigation & Interpretation of Problem statement (5)	Design / Prototype (5)	Interpretation of Data & Dataset (3)	Modern Tool Usage (5)	Societal & Environmental Benefit, Safety Consideration (2)	Ethics (2)	Cost effectiveness (2)	Team work (2)	Presentation Skills (3)	Engg. Mgmt principles & Standards Applied (3)	Life - long learning (3)	Professional Skills (5)	Innovative Approach (5)	Total Marks (50)
Review of Project Stage I	4	5	4	3	4	2	2	2	2	3	3	3	4	4	45
Comments:															
Date: 17th October, 2025															
Name & Signature Reviewer 2															